

INBRIEF



Road named after late Major Mukund Varadarajan

The State government has issued orders for naming a road in Tambaram after late Army officer and martyr Major Mukund Varadarajan. The naming of the road after the Ashoka Chakra recipient followed a request from the Army. The road named after the late Army officer connects Tambaram railway station with Velachery and is within the Tambaram City Municipal Corporation limits. The late Major hailed from Ananthapuram and was a student of Madras Christian College, an official release said.

Councillors complain about vacancies in Health Dept.

GCC Councillors complained about rising vacancies in the civic body's Health Department. At the Council Meeting on Wednesday, councillors said the GCC should take measures to fill vacancies for doctors, nurses, and sanitary inspectors. Councillors have complained about inadequate number of doctors and nurses in wards 144, 146, 150 and 155. They have also complained that the health and wellness centres developed in the second phase did not have air conditioning. GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran has inspected hospitals in various parts of the city and directed officials to improve services. The Commisioner said: "The Councillors spoke about vacancies in UPHCs and health and wellness centres. The vacancies under the NUHM were filled on November 3, 2024, and the further vacancies were filled using the waiting list through orders of the Commissioner dated May 13, 2026. The posts of medical officers and staff nurses (permanent positions) will be filled through the Medical Services Recruitment Board. Others will be filled from the waiting list of candidates."

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on The Hindu epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (June 25, Thursday), the following articles are available:

- Why did Delhi High Court quash charges against NewsClick? [newsth.live/newslick](#)
- Meet the insects that make India's famed mangoes [newsth.live/mangomakers](#)

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

City hospital treats man who suffered cardiac arrest during angiography

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 69-year-old man who came to MGM Healthcare nearly two days after first experiencing symptoms of a heart attack and then suffered a cardiac arrest during an angiography, was successfully treated at the hospital.

Addressing a press conference on Wednesday, Babu Ezhumalai, Senior Consultant, Interventional Cardiology, Structural and Endovascular Interventions, said that the man, when he came in, was found to have low blood pressure and his heart was not pumping adequately.

An emergency angiography was carried out, which revealed critical blockages in the heart. During this procedure, the patient suffered a cardiac arrest, he said.

Dr. Ezhumalai explained that the patient given CPR immediately, followed by mechanical circulatory support with an intra-aortic balloon pump. However, his blood pressure continued to remain low.

He said, in this situation, it was thought fit to put him on ECMO, an external device that does the job of the heart and lungs, oxygenating and pumping blood back into the body. His blood pressure then stabilised. Subsequently, doctors were able to perform a complex angioplasty and stenting procedure.

The patient gradually improved and was weaned off ECMO. Follow-up checks showed a recovery of heart function, with a normal ejection fraction of 53%. Dr. Ezhumalai said, and the patient is back to his regular activities.

Residents allege property tax assessment by GCC is wrong

Residents of 1,840 apartments in Mogappair West have demanded that the Corporation revise its tax assessment; they say the community will lose ₹30 lakh a year due to the incorrect calculation

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Residents of 1,840 apartments in Mogappair West have alleged that the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) has erroneously calculated property tax for homes that have been assessed this year. They have demanded that the GCC revise the assessment.

At the Corporation Council meeting on Wednesday, Valasaravakkam Zone chairman Nolambur Rajan said each of the families have to pay additional tax as the GCC has calculated ₹30 lakh more than the actual tax assessment. Mayor R. Priya said the civic body will study the issue and take a decision shortly.

A resident of the apart-



A GCC official said the civic body would check whether the properties concerned have been underassessed. FILE PHOTO

ment complex said they submitted petitions against the erroneous property tax calculation in March.

"After we pointed out the incorrect assessment, we were forced to pay the tax during the year-end in

March. After the elections, we tried again. But we are yet to get a solution. Our community will lose ₹30 lakh per year because of the incorrect calculation," the resident said.

For 1,062 sq.ft. of super

built-up area of 2BHK apartments in the sale deed, the GCC has calculated property tax for 1,498 sq.ft., while owners of 1,288 sq.ft. apartments pay tax for 1,728 sq.ft. Owners of flats with a super built-up area of 1,657 sq.ft. have to pay tax for 2,103 sq.ft., the residents said.

A GCC official said the civic body will check whether the properties have been underassessed. The GCC has assessed more than 14 lakh properties for tax collection.

GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran said, "The Councillor was referring to a specific case where he has alleged area mismatch; the properties concerned will be remeasured in the presence of the assessee and appropriate action will be taken."

Councillors urge GCC not to collect fee for sports facilities on OSR lands

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Councillors have urged the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) to stop collecting fee for sports facilities developed on OSR lands earmarked in residential layouts.

At the GCC Council meeting on Wednesday, Councillors alleged that residents were opposing the move to collect a fee from residents who use the sports facilities on OSR lands. For instance, residents in ward 153 have demanded the GCC to stop collecting a fee for the badminton court, while residents of ward 151 have opposed the fee collection in a skating facility. The OSR land was meant to be used for recreation by the owners of the houses in the layout. Another badminton court in ward 149 has also been

developed on a OSR land and residents have to pay for visiting the facility. Ward 84 councillor J. John said the sports facility in his ward was developed on the OSR land under the *Namakku Naamae Thittam* and the residents were paying money for using the facilities.

Valasaravakkam zone chairman Nolambur Rajan said it is unethical to collect money for recreation from the owners of the land.

GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran said, "Regarding user charges for play facilities like badminton court, tennis court, etc. it is done as per Council resolution and the purpose is to have good maintenance of the facility and create ownership among the community. The user charges are far less than the market rates."

DMK seeks display of Stalin's photos at Ward Committee meetings

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Photos of former Chief Minister M.K. Stalin should be permitted to be displayed at Ward Committee meetings as per an earlier Government Order, stated GCC Standing Committee Chairman N. Chitrarasu at the council meeting on Wednesday. Photos of Chief Minister C. Josphe Vijay and that of Mr. Stalin were seen placed at the council hall of the Ripon Buildings. Deputy Mayor M. Magesh Kumar, DMK councillors, and Ward Committee chairman supported the request.

Mayor R. Priya said that since only eight months remained in the term of the current council and her Mayorship this can be implemented for Ward Committee meetings.

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PERSONAL	PERSONAL
ANNOUNCEMENTS	CHANGE OF NAME
I. NAME: R. Veerajayan, No. 13852595Y Rank : Ex-Sep [Retd.] S/o. Late .V. Ramaiyan, Residing at No. 14, 4th Street, Brindavan Nagar, CRPF Camp, Avadi, Chennai - 600065, I State that in My Pension Payment Order [No.240198800095] My wife's [V. Malika] Date of Birth is mentioned as 03.02.1964 instead of 25.05.1962. Her Correct Date of Birth is 25.05.1962. Affidavit No. FG 099189.	I, ANILKUMAR CHORDIA MOHANLAL CHORDIA S/o. Mohanlal Chordia, DoB : 04/09/1974, Residing at Old # 47, New # 120, Appu Street, Mylapore, Chennai-600004. Henceforth be known as ANILKUMAR CHORDIA. I, M.MUTHULAKSHMI, wife of Thiru M. Jothiraman (PPO No. 807200301547), retired from Ordnance Factories Board, DOO FU AVADI, born on 18 January 1962 in Tiruvallur District and residing at Old No. 105, New No. 23, Pudukachery Road, Ponneri, Tiruvallur - 601204, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as J. Muniyammal for all purposes. I, JAYANTHI CHORDIA ANIL KUMAR CHORDIA W/o. Anil Kumar Chordia, DoB: 08/05/1977, Residing at Old # 47, New # 120, Appu Street, Mylapore, Chennai 600004. Henceforth be known as JAYANTHI CHORDIA. I, SUGANTHI Gopal, wife of Thiru Gopal, born on 30th May 1979 (District of Birth: Chennai), residing at No. 87A, East Main Road, Shankar Nagar, Pammal, Chennai-600 075, shall henceforth be known as SUGANTHI JAYARAMAN. Chennai, 12th June 2026.SUGANTHI GOPAL
CHANGE OF NAME	OLD AGE HOME
I, SUNIL KUMAR CHORDIA SAGARMAL CHORDIA S/o. M Sagarmal Chordia, DoB: 04/09/1974, Residing at Old # 47, New # 120, Appu Street, Mylapore, Chennai - 600004. Henceforth be known as SUNIL KUMAR CHORDIA. I, RONAK CHORDIA ANILKUMAR CHORDIA S/o. M Anilkumar Chordia, DoB: 06/10/2005, Residing at Old # 47, New # 120, Appu Street, Mylapore, Chennai 600004. Henceforth be known as RONAK CHORDIA. I, KANTHA CHORDIA SAGARMAL CHORDIA W/o. Sagarmal Chordia, DoB: 07/10/1946, Residing at Old # 47, New # 120, Appu Street, Mylapore Chennai - 600004. Henceforth be known as KANTHA CHORDIA. I, VINITH CHORDIA ANIL KUMAR CHORDIA S/o. M Anil Kumar Chordia, DoB: 24/11/1999, Residing at Old # 47, New # 120, Appu Street, Mylapore, Chennai - 600004. Henceforth be known as VINITH CHORDIA. I, JINESH CHORDIA RAJESH KUMAR CHORDIA S/o. Rajesh Kumar Chordia, DoB: 28/08/2004, Residing at Old # 47, New # 120, Appu Street, Mylapore, Chennai - 600004. Henceforth be known as JINESH CHORDIA. I, BHANU Sridar aged 61 years wife of Service No.667221F Sgt Kalyanakrishnamurthy Sridar Residing at 8, Bellevue Apartment, Bharathi Nagar 1st street, Old Perungalathur Chennai 600063 do affirm as under. I am Depo- nent herein confirm that my name in my husband's service records is wrongly spelled and entered as Bhanu Sridhar by oversight. I confirm that my correct spelling is Bhanu Sridar, as mentioned in Dependent certificate and Discharge Book issued by Indian Air Forceand as per my Aadhaar Card and Pan Card. I, RAJKUMARI CHORDIA SUNIL KUMAR CHORDIA W/o.S Sunil Kumar Chordia , DoB: 17/07/1973, Residing at Old # 47, New # 120, Appu Street, Mylapore, Chennai - 600004. Henceforth be known as RAJKUMARI CHORDIA.	PALLIATIVE CARE at your home Trained Nurses, 24/7. Dr., Physio visits, Lab tests 1800-313-1883 tikotra.com/seniors

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THE HINDU PRESENTS **SCHOOL BUZZ**
A Newspaper exclusively curated for School Students

SAPLING PLANTATION DRIVE

Maharishi Vidya Mandir School, Irungattukottai, observed World Environment Day with a sapling plantation initiative aimed at promoting environmental awareness and conservation. Students actively participated by bringing plant saplings and spreading awareness about the importance of protecting nature. The programme encouraged students to develop a sense of responsibility towards the environment and adopt sustainable living practices. Through the activity, students pledged to contribute towards a greener future. The initiative highlighted the role of trees in maintaining ecological balance, reducing pollution and creating a healthier environment, while reinforcing the message that small actions can lead to meaningful change.

WORLD ENVIRONMENT DAY OBSERVED

Jeppiaar School CBSE observed World Environment Day with a sapling plantation initiative. As the saplings took root, students imbibed the values of responsibility, sustainability and environmental consciousness, reinforcing their commitment to a greener future.

NEW SCHOOL INAUGURATED

Jawahar Global Academy, the latest educational initiative of Stree Seva Mandir, was formally inaugurated by Mr. R. Sabarinathan, MLA and Chief Government Whip of the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly, and Dr. R. Sivakumar, IPS. The institution builds on the legacy of Jawahar Vidyalaya, which is celebrating 60 years of educational excellence. The academy offers smart classrooms, digital learning tools, modern laboratories, a library, sports facilities and leadership programmes. Mr. R. Sabarinathan praised their holistic approach to education, while Dr. R. Sivakumar highlighted the role of parents in child development. Vice President Mr. Diwakar Yerra outlined the institution's vision of quality, values-based education.

For Subscription related queries, please contact Subramaniam P:
Handphone:+91 98408 98088 | Email: subramaniam.p@thehindu.co.in

Dharman is Rajinikanth’s 173rd film, Ashwath Marimuthu to direct it

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Dharman is the title of Superstar Rajinikanth's much-anticipated 173rd film, as announced by the makers on Tuesday. With the announcement, it is now clear that director Ashwath Marimuthu (*Oh My Kadavule*, *Dragon* fame) has replaced Cibi Chakaravarthi (of *Don* fame) as the director.

The title of the film was unveiled at the film's launch event in Chennai. Actor-producer Kamal Haasan's Raaj Kamal Films International, the banner bankrolling the project, released a first-look poster of the film at the event to announce the news.

The poster features Rajinikanth as a surgeon with a violent streak. 'The Deadly Doctor,' is written as the tagline of the film. Notably, there have been films fea-



Director Ashwath Marimuthu with Kamal Haasan, Rajinikanth, and Mahendran of Raaj Kamal Films International at the event held to launch the film. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

ture Rajinikanth 'Dharma' in the title, like 1991's *Dharma Durai* and 1988's *Dharmathin Thalaivan*. *Dharman* stars Simran, Raashi Khanna, and Yogi Babu in the lead. With music scored by Anirudh Ravichander, the film has cinematography by Niketh Bommi and editing by Pradeep E. Ragav.

Thalaivar 173 was officially announced last year. Rajinikanth and Kamal Haasan, apart from teaming up for their much-awaited reunion film (directed by Nelson), have also collaborated on Thalaivar 173, with Kamal taking on the role of the producer.

While speaking at the event, Rajinikanth acknow-

ledged the multiple changes in the film's director pick. "This project was originally set to be directed by K.S. Ravikumar. But that didn't work out, and then we had Sundar C. on board. However, he had to exit the project due to his other film commitments. Then came Cibi Chakaravarthi; I really liked Cibi's story, but it was a very sensitive subject. It was about a nuclear scientist, and it demanded shooting in Afghanistan and Russia. Moreover, it seemed like a very time-consuming project, which is why we couldn't do it. Then we roped in Ashwath Marimuthu," said Rajinikanth.

Given how long the two stalwarts have been searching for a perfect script to collaborate on, there are tremendous expectations surrounding the project.

Youth jumps onto Metro Rail tracks, gets injured

CHENNAI: A 27-year-old youth sustained injuries after he jumped onto the tracks at Ekkatuthangal Metro Rail station on Wednesday. The incident occurred at 1.34 p.m., when a train from Koyambedu bound for St. Thomas Mount was entering the station. He was immediately rushed to a hospital in

Saidapet and is undergoing treatment. There was a ten-minute delay in the train services and normal services resumed by 2 p.m.

(Assistance for overcoming suicidal thoughts is available on the State health helpline 104, Tele-MANAS 14416 and Sneha's suicide prevention helpline 044-24640050)

Timings CHENNAI			
THURSDAY, JUN. 25			
RISE	05:45	SET	18:38
RISE	14:53	SET	01:51
FRIDAY, JUN. 26			
RISE	05:46	SET	18:39
RISE	15:44	SET	02:32
SATURDAY, JUN. 27			
RISE	05:46	SET	18:39
RISE	16:36	SET	03:17

THE HINDU
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Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	37	26
Chennai Airport	37	28
Chennai City	35	27

Chennai Airport Today
36°C The weather will be very warm and uneasy. Night will also be very uneasy. Spell of light rain and thundershowers may occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
37°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Chances of light rain and thundershowers. Night will also be uneasy.

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APPOINTMENT



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CINEMA ♦ ARTS ♦ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

The Music Academy Madras
Today: At the Kasturi Srinivasan Hall 6.00 p.m. to 7.30 p.m. – Mysore Vasudevachar Day – Sweta Balasubramanian (Vocal), S.P. Ananthapadmanabha (Violin), Thillaiathanam Dr. R Suriyanarayanan (Mridangam) – Programme under the endowment instituted by late Smt. Gomathi Viswanathan through Kala Mandir Trust.

PUSHPANJALI CULTURAL TRUST
Today 5.30pm at R.K Swamy auditorium mylapore Bharathanatyam by Ms. Sheela Ranganathan 7pm Bharathanatyam by Kum. T.V. ANANYA Dis.of Smt. Lakshmi Priya R

MISCELLANEOUS

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CORRIGENDUM NO. 1 AGAINST TENDER NOTICE NO. M-TSK-2026-19
Corrigendum no. 1 against Tender Notice No. M-TSK-2026-19. Date: 05-06-2026 has been uploaded. The tender submission and opening date now to be read as under:
1. Last date and time for submission of tender at 15:00 hrs. on 20-07-2026.
2. Date and time of opening of tender at 15:30 hrs. on 20-07-2026.
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Chief Guest
SMT. NIRMALA SITHARAMAN
Hon'ble Union Minister for Finance & Corporate Affairs
Government of India will release the book

One of the Earliest Schools started Exclusively for girls in Tamil Nadu has under its management. Six Schools and a College run on Separate Campuses. Today, more than 10,000 Students study under the Umbrella of S.S.K.V.

Thursday, 25 June 2026
Timing: 11.00 a.m.

S.S.K.V. College of Arts and Science for Women, Kancheepuram

Dr.Nanditha Krishna
President

Dr.C.K.Raman
Secretary

SDA will take over if disputes between sports associations persist, says Minister



Sports Minister Aadhav Arjuna presenting a cheque to chess champion B. Savitha on Tuesday. Ministers Rajmohan, S. Keerthana, and P. Viswanathan and other dignitaries are also seen. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

If a dispute between sports associations remains unresolved for many months together, the Sports Development Authority of Tamil Nadu (SDATN) will take over the administration till they are resolved and rules in this regard are being framed, Minister for Public Works and Sports Development Aadhav Arjuna said in Chennai on Tuesday.

The government will soon provide for flight tickets for all State-level teams that will represent the State in sports events in other States, Mr. Arjuna said. The Minister also said the prize money for a sports event should be the same for both the men and women teams. On the occasion, the SDATN signed a memorandum of understanding with JSW Inspire Institute of Sport.

In his speech at the International Olympic Day celebrations at Jawaharlal Nehru Indoor Stadium in Chennai, Mr. Arjuna elaborated on some of the plans of the Sports Development Department. Soon, air-conditioning facilities will be installed in accommodations for sportspersons, he said.

Sports reforms

Recalling his long association with the sports hostel, Mr. Arjuna said sports was his life and called upon sportspersons to take up

lessons learned from sports in their day-to-day life. The Minister also advocated for cleaning up the system and to bring out reforms in sports.

During his speech, Minister for Higher Education P. Viswanathan urged Mr. Arjuna to take steps to increase the reservation in the selection for appointment of meritorious sportspersons in government departments and public sector from the existing 3% to 5% or 7%.

Sandeep Nanduri, Secretary, Sports Development, said his department was about to undergo a transformation and employ many innovations. Major focus would be on world-class infrastructure, he said. He pointed out that special focus had been accorded to nutrition for sportspersons and said various grants had been increased.

Focus on Olympics

J. Meghanatha Reddy, Member-Secretary, SDATN, said all activities would be focussed on getting medals in the Olympics. He said this was the first time the SDATN was organising the International Olympic Day celebrations at this scale, inviting and honouring Olympians.

Minister for School Education Rajmohan, Industries Minister S. Keerthana, and Manisha Malhotra, president, JSW Inspire Institute of Sport, also spoke.

Constable dies after being knocked down by car

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The death toll in a road accident caused by a speeding car on the Chennai-Bengaluru Highway near Poonamallee on Sunday climbed to two, with a 25-

year-old police constable succumbing to his injuries on Wednesday. The accident occurred when a car veered out of control and knocked them down.

The Poonamallee Traffic Investigation police arrested the driver of the car.

Freemasons celebrate Universal Brotherhood Day

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

To celebrate the spirit of Universal Brotherhood Day, The Grand Lodge of India (GLI) that governs Freemasonry in India, awarded grants to NGOs and individuals in need. The financial assistance was primarily intended for individuals seeking educational support.

“Charity remains one of the fundamental pillars of Freemasonry. Masonic charitable activities have included healthcare support, construction of community facilities, housing projects for disaster-affected families, educational assistance and so on,” says Gutha Krishnan Selvarajan, GLI’s 19th grand-master.

“Today, we have given assistance worth ₹75 lakh and it is going to benefit many groups of people in dire need,” he said.

Chief Guest Swami Shanta Chittananda Maharaj of Sri Ramakrishna Math and Guest of Honour, orator Bharrathi Bhaskar, also participated.

Three months after launch of MRTS extension, trains yet to halt at Adambakkam

Stoppage provisions were not provided at Adambakkam due to a platform alignment issue detected during an inspection; official says a design is being prepared, the work will be over soon

TRACK TALES

R. Srikanth
CHENNAI

Three months have passed since the launch of the Mass Rapid Transit system (MRTS) extension project from Velachery to St. Thomas Mount, but there is no provision for halts at the Adambakkam railway station.

The MRTS extension project was inaugurated on March 14 this year and full-scale suburban train services started between St. Thomas Mount and Chennai Beach stations. However, of the two railway stations on the extension line – Adambakkam and Puz-



Safety check: A Southern Railway official says that civic works, barring an increase in platform height, have been completed at Adambakkam station. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

hithivakkam – trains were not allowed to stop at Adambakkam after Chief Commissioner of Railway Safety (CCRS) Janak Kumar Garg found infringement in the platform alignment

during his inspection.

When Mr. Garg, who also held the Commissioner of Railway Safety (Southern circle) post, gave the provisional certificate to start services on the MRTS

extension stretch, he had included several restrictions, including no stoppage provisions at the Adambakkam station and a severe speed restriction.

A Southern Railway official said that at present, civic works, barring increasing the platform height, had been completed at the Adambakkam station. The main issue was the platform alignment, which Mr. Garg wanted at the All India standardised level.

“The Research Designs and Standard Organisation (RDSO) has to provide the design for this, and once the design is ready, the platform alignment will be corrected within a month. We hope to finish it by July,” he said.

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

श्रद्धांजलि



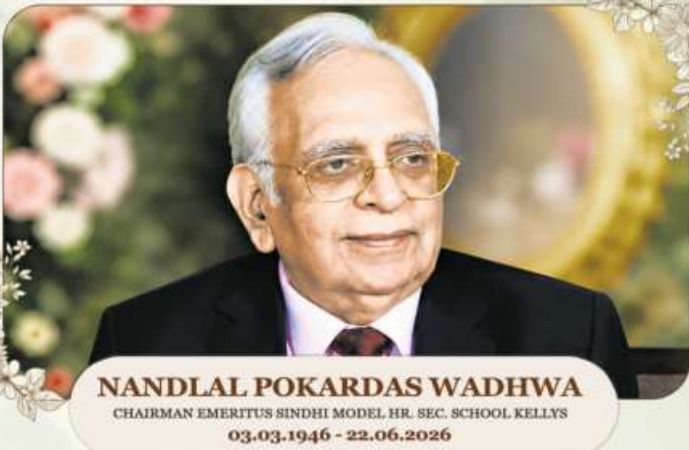
We express our heartfelt condolences on the sad demise of our beloved Chairman Emeritus

Shri Nandlal Pokardas Wadhwa
(03.03.1946 - 22.06.2026)

His exemplary leadership, dedication to education, and invaluable service to the Sindh Educational Society will always be remembered with deep respect and gratitude.

In Grief
Management and Staff of
Sindh Educational Society (Madras)
Seth P. D. Hinduja Sindh Model Senior Secondary School
Sindh College
Sindh Model Matriculation Higher Secondary School
Sindh Model School Of Excellence

IN LOVING
Memory
of



NANDLAL POKARDAS WADHWA
CHAIRMAN EMERITUS SINDHI MODEL HR. SEC. SCHOOL KELLYS
03.03.1946 - 22.06.2026

MOURNED BY UMA, AARTI, SHILPA, NIELS, SUMIT
&
THE ENTIRE WADHWA & DODEJA FAMILY

CHAUTHA | PRAYER MEET
Thursday, 25 June 2026, 4:30PM - 5:00PM

Sindh Model Senior Secondary School
No. 1, Damodaran Street, Kellys, Chennai - 600010

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES

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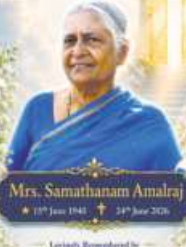
DONATE EYES - GIFT SIGHT

DEATH

OBITUARY

From 12.00 - 12.00 PM To the convenience of the family members, the funeral will be held at the residence of the deceased.

A loving Mother, Grandmother & Great Niece in the Home



Mrs. Samathanam Amalraj
19th June 1946 - 24th June 2026

Lovingly remembered by:
Joshi Vijaya, Mitha Nisha, Aggar Sahasra, Kishan Hanuman & Family Members

Funeral: 25th June 2026, 11:00 AM
G.D. Chatterjee & Sons, New Market

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

EIGHTH ANNIVERSARY



M. MANGAYARKARASI ACHI
Born: 01.11.1945 - Died: 25.06.2018

Fondly remembered by:
L. Muthukrishnan - Husband
Daughter, Son
Son-in-law, Daughter-in-law & Grand children

First Anniversary



Mr. C.V. Nagarathinam
DOB: 27.06.1938 - DOD: 25.06.2025

Retd. HGA, LIC of India

In Remembrance
Mrs. Rajeswari Nagarathinam,
Son, Daughter & family
Ct: 98841 67746 / 95662 07054

3rd Year Anniversary



Mrs. R. MYTHILI, M.A.

Husband: **M. RAJASEKARAN, B.A.B.L.**
Advocate - High Court, Chennai
Son: **R. VIJAYA BALAJI, B.E.**
Daughter: **R. SRINIPRATHIBA, B.E., B.Ed.**
Son in Law: **S. MAGESH KUMAR, B.E., MBA,**
and Family Members & Relatives
Kilpauk, Chennai & Srivilliputhur, Ph: 98400 64288

IN LOVING MEMORY OF



Smt. Jayalakshmi **Sri. K.V. Rajagopalan**
DOB: 16.08.1927 DOB: 26.11.1918
DOD: 17.12.2004 DOD: 25.06.2001

Fondly Remembered by
Children, Grand Children & Great Grand Children



The blood donation van was formally handed over by Rotarian AKS. Muruganandam at Dr. MGR Janaki College in the city.

Rotary Club donates blood donation van to centre in Kolathur

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Rotary Club of Madras (RCM) and Rotary Club of Chennai Legends (RCCL), with Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) support from Vara Future LLP, donated a fully equipped blood donation van worth ₹35 lakh to the National Vo-

luntary Blood Donation Centre, Kolathur. The mobile blood donation unit was formally handed over by Rotarian AKS. Muruganandam at a function held at Dr. MGR Janaki College in Chennai.

The state-of-the-art van will take blood donation services across Chennai at no cost.

KERALA BANK
PB.No.6515, COBANK TOWERS, VIKAS BHAVAN,P.O. PALAYAM, THIRUVANANTHAPURAM., PIN-695033

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-tenders are invited from the Public Sector Insurance Companies (Through their Regional Offices or Divisional Offices) or from Insurance Broking Companies having a registered office in Kerala State approved by IRDA representing the Public Sector Insurance Companies, for the renewal of (1) Group Medical Insurance policy for Permanent Employees, Gold Appraisers, Collection Agents and their family, (2) Night Watchmen, Security, Contract, Daily Waged Employees and their family, (3) Parent/Parent-in-law of Employees, Retired Employees & their Spouse, (4) Group Personal Accident Insurance (Death Only) for Permanent Employees of the Bank. E-tender documents can be obtained from e-tender website of Kerala State Government (www.etenders.kerala.gov.in) and details are also available in the Bank's Website: <https://kerala.bank.in>

Tender ID: 2026_KSCB_857409_1

The cut-off date for submission of E-tenders is **6.00 p.m., 16/07/2026** (Sd/-)
Thiruvananthapuram
24/06/2026 Chief Executive Officer

MADURAI CORPORATION
RE-TENDER NOTIFICATION
NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING

Madurai Corporation invites two cover bids from eligible contractors for the below mentioned works Funded under KfW (SMIF-TN-III), CGF and Corporation Fund 2025-26

Name of Work	Bid Submission Date	Bid Opening Date
E1/EST 001057 / 2026 (2nd Call) Execution of River Front Development works on the Northern side and Southern side bank of Vaigai River in Madurai Corporation Tender Put Value - Rs.79.26 Cr (Incl. GST)	25.06.2026 To 28.07.2026 3.00pm	28.07.2026 4.00pm

Pre-Bid Meeting Date And Time : 08.07.2026 , 3.00 PM

Other Details can be found at <http://www.tntenders.gov.in> Website
Contact No: 0452-25403332 DIPR/2125/DISPLAY/2026

COMMISSIONER
MADURAI CORPORATION

Admission Notice (2026-27)

Uttar Pradesh State Institute of Forensic Science, Lucknow
Aurawan, Daroga Kheda, P.O. Banthra, Lucknow -226401

UPSIFS, Lucknow (Established in 2021) functioning under the aegis of the Home Department, Govt. of U.P. & affiliated with the National Forensic Science University, Gandhinagar, Gujarat, invites the applications and to register admission in the Institute for the B.Sc.-M.Sc. Forensic Science (Five-Year Integrated programme) in the forthcoming Academic Session: 2026-27. For Registration & other details please visit website www.upsifs.ac.in or e-mail to admission@upsifs.ac.in. The last date for applications 15 July 2026.

UPID Ro.: 252972 Sd/-
R.o. Dt: 24/06/2026 Assistant Registrar (Academics)
Website: www.up.gov.in UPSIFS, Lucknow

Health

MUKH MANTRI SEHAT YOJANA & AAM AADMI CLINICS EMERGE AS PUNJAB’S HEALTH REVOLUTION CORNERSTONES

₹10 LAKH CASHLESS COVER PER FAMILY & 990 CLINICS WITH 5.62 CRORE VISITS TRANSFORM HEALTHCARE LANDSCAPE

CHIEF MINISTER BHAGWANT SINGH MANN REITERATES COMMITMENT TO UNIVERSAL HEALTH ACCESS TO ALL PUNJABIS

The Mukh Mantri Sehat Yojana and the network of Aam Aadmi Clinics have emerged as the twin pillars of Punjab's health revolution under the Bhagwant Singh Mann-led government, building a seamless ecosystem from grassroots wellness to super-speciality care. The government has successfully transitioned Punjab to absolute Universal Health Coverage, ensuring comprehensive financial medical protection for all 3 crore residents.

A Historic Leap in Social

Security:

The Mukh Mantri Sehat Yojana offers cashless treatment of up to ₹10 lakh per family per year, with no income caps or exclusion criteria — giving every citizen, including government employees, identical elite-tier medical safeguards. CM Bhagwant Singh Mann said, "Our goal is to ensure that no family in Punjab has to choose between financial stability and life-saving treatment. The health revolution in the state is about

dignity and access for every citizen." The scheme covers over 2,000 clinical procedures, from cardiology and oncology to specialised surgeries. The administration has generated over 46 lakh health cards, enabling 386,240 treatments worth approximately ₹637.63 crore. For Gurbinder Jeet Singh, a driver from Patiala, the scheme proved life-changing when his mother Baljit Kaur was diagnosed with uterine cancer. "In the first few weeks, we

spent over ₹60,000. As a driver, arranging more money was difficult. I started thinking about loans and selling belongings," he said. After registering under the scheme, his mother underwent around 12 chemotherapy sessions and an eight-hour surgery - care that would otherwise have cost ₹8–10 lakh. In another case, 98-year-old Mukhtiar Kaur received specialised cancer treatment, including chemotherapy-related care, fully covered under the Sehat Card - ensuring

medical decisions were driven by need, not financial constraints.

Revolutionizing Primary Healthcare Complementing this safety net: The Government has established 990 Aam Aadmi Clinics - 414 urban and 576 rural - decentralising primary



healthcare for vulnerable and marginalised communities. These IT-based clinics provide

107 essential drugs and 47 diagnostic tests free of cost, with real-time reporting. They have recorded a total footfall of over 5.62 crore patients, averaging 84 patients per clinic daily - reaching about 83,000 patients every day. Over 3.43 crore diagnostic tests have been performed free of cost. Services have expanded to include pregnancy care, malnourishment screening, dog bite treatment, family planning, hypertension,

diabetes, and oral cancer care. Each month, over 35,000 pregnant women receive ante-natal care, while more than 1,15,000 people are treated for diabetes and hypertension. Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann reiterated, "The expansion of the Mukh Mantri Sehat Yojana and the network of Aam Aadmi Clinics is a testament to our commitment to a 'Health Revolution' in Punjab. We are ensuring that from primary care to critical surgeries, the government stands with its people."

Women Empowerment

Maavan-Dheeyan Satkar Yojna

3 Months' 'Maavan Dheeyan Satkar Rashi' To Be Credited to Every Eligible Woman's Account on July 1: CM Bhagwant Singh Mann

Marking a historic step towards women's economic empowerment, Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann announced that the countdown for the Maavan Dheeyan Satkar Yojna has begun, with the first instalment of three months Satkar Rashi set to be credited directly into the bank accounts of eligible women on 1st July. Under the scheme, Dalit mothers and sisters will receive ₹4,500, while women from all other categories will get ₹3,000. During a Lok Milni programme after inaugurating various development works in Village Chanarthal Kalan of Fatehgarh Sahib Constituency, CM Bhagwant Singh Mann said the initiative reflects the State Government's commitment to

ensuring dignity, financial security, and social empowerment for women, adding that the assistance will continue uninterrupted as long as Bhagwant Singh Mann led Punjab Government remains in Punjab. On July 1, women beneficiaries above the age of 18 years will receive notifications on their mobile phones informing them about the financial assistance being credited to their accounts. Women belonging to the general category will receive ₹1,000 per month while Scheduled Caste women will receive ₹1,500 per month. The money will be transferred directly into their bank accounts without any middlemen. Women who are already receiving social security



pensions will also be eligible under the scheme. Nearly 97% women in Punjab are expected to benefit from this initiative and the Punjab Government has made a budgetary provision of ₹9,300 crore for it.

The Chief Minister stated, "This financial assistance may not make women rich, but it will certainly give them dignity, self-

respect and confidence. Women deserve the highest respect because they are the source of life itself. The blessings of mothers and sisters help overcome every challenge in the world.

Strengthening women's financial autonomy is essential for improving household welfare, promoting gender equity and enhancing women's participation in social and economic decision-making. When women become financially empowered, families prosper and society moves forward."

Jobs

Punjab Hands Out 523 More Health Department Jobs, Crosses 67,500 Recruitment Mark

Govt Jobs had become Dream for Youth Under Previous Govts as Money, Not Merit, was deciding factor: CM Bhagwant Singh Mann

Handing over appointment letters to 523 youths in the Health Department on June 16, Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann said his government has ended the era when government jobs were sold through money and political influence, depriving deserving candidates of opportunities.

Citing the creation of 67,563 government jobs in four years through a transparent, merit-based process, Chief Minister said the state has restored faith in public recruitment and reversed the trend of youth leaving Punjab for employment elsewhere. He contrasted this record with examination controversies seen in other

states. "It is a matter of immense pride that more than 67,500 government jobs have been provided to youth across the state. The era of cash payments and favouritism has ended," said CM adding that not even a single appointment made by our Government has been challenged in court. The faith of youth in the recruitment process has been restored.

Since taking office in 2022, the Punjab Government has made appointments across multiple departments: School Education (16,316),



Home Affairs (14,723), Power (8,306), Local Government (5,681), Health and Family Welfare (4,235), Revenue, Rehabilitation and Disaster Management (2,355), Medical Education and Research (2,143), and Water Resources (2,168). The latest drive added 523 appointments in Health and Family Welfare alone.

The Chief Minister emphasized that for decades, deserving youth were deprived of opportunities because jobs were distributed through recommendations and influence — a system he says has been completely eradicated. Appointments are now made purely on merit and eligibility, he said, ensuring every candidate knows hard work and talent are sufficient to secure a government job. The government has framed the recruitment drive as part of a broader push toward transparent governance, running alongside expanded healthcare and public welfare initiatives across the state.

Sports

Punjab's Sporting Revolution: "Khed-da Punjab, Badalda Punjab"

PUNJAB ALL SET TO REGAIN PRISTINE GLORY IN SPORTS, HARMANPREET SINGH, HARMANPREET KAUR, HARLEEN DEOL TERM AS UNPRECEDENTED THE HONOURS BESTOWED

Under Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann's leadership, Punjab's sports sector has undergone a sweeping

Massive Budget and Infrastructure Push: The sports budget has been raised to an all-time high of

heritage, noting that Guru Sahiban promoted physical fitness alongside spirituality, and that the government is simply "giving wings" to this spirit.

Punjab Athletes Leading National Teams: Punjab's sporting dominance is reflected in its athletes captaining national squads: Harmanpreet Singh led India's hockey team and was the 2024 Paris Olympics' top scorer with 10 goals; Shubman Gill captains the Men's Cricket Team; Harmanpreet Kaur led the Women's Cricket Team to ODI World Cup glory, featuring Punjab stars Amanjot Kaur and Harleen Deol; Palpreet Singh Brar captains the basketball team; and Gurpreet Singh Sandhu has captained the football team.

In a historic first, Punjab will host the Asian Champions Trophy Hockey tournament 2026 in October 2026, with matches at Mohali's Balbir Singh Senior Hockey Stadium and Jalandhar's Surjit Hockey Stadium.

Financial Support and Grassroots Growth: A 2023 Sports Policy introduced advance cash grants — ₹15 lakh for Olympic preparation and ₹8 lakh for Asian/Commonwealth Games

preparation — contributing to Punjab winning a record 20 medals at the 2023 Asian Games. Paris Olympic bronze medallists and Asian Games gold medallists each received ₹1 crore, while nine Olympic medallists were given government jobs as PCS and DSP officers. Nearly ₹100 crore in prize money has been

from 1.5 lakh participants in 2022–23 to 5 lakh in 2024–25, spanning age groups from under-14 to over 60, including Para-Sports. Preserving Rural Sporting Traditions: The Punjab Assembly unanimously passed the Prevention of Cruelty to



disbursed over four years, extended for the first time to Punjabi athletes representing the armed forces.

Athlete nutrition support has doubled, from ₹240 to ₹480 daily, alongside a new Nutrition-Based Menu across 13 Centres of Excellence. The grassroots tournament "Khedda Watan Punjab Diya" has grown

Animals (Punjab Amendment) Bill-2025 on July 11, 2025, reviving Bull-Cart Racing and other heritage sports at the Kila Raipur Games. Punjab also became the first state to establish a dedicated Sports Medicine Cadre, and launched a single-window Sports Portal for registration, gradation, and record verification.

YUDH NASHIAN VIRUDH

Punjab Police Score Major Wins in War Against Drugs and Organised Crime

YUDH NASHIAN VIRUDH: 48,428 NDPS FIRs, 63,626 ARRESTS, 3064 KG HEROIN SEIZED SINCE MARCH 1, 2025

89,594 RAIDS CONDUCTED UNDER "GANGSTRAN TE VAAR"; 36,381 HELD SINCE JANUARY 20, 2026

Acting on directions from Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann, Punjab Police have achieved significant success through two flagship campaigns — "Yudh Nashian Virudh" and "Gangstran Te Vaar" — aimed at dismantling the narcotics trade and neutralising gangster networks across the state. Yudh Nashian Virudh: Targeting the Drug Trade Launched on March 1, 2025, the anti-drug campaign combines strict enforcement, community involvement, and preventive education. "The war against drugs is not just a police operation; it is a fight for the future of our youth and the soul of Punjab," CM said, vowing that the crackdown would continue until every peddler and smuggler is brought to justice.

Since its launch, police have registered 48,428 FIRs under the NDPS Act and arrested 63,626 accused, including 3,646 linked to commercial-quantity cases. The operation has netted 3,631 drug suppliers and 579 "big fish." Major recoveries include 3,064 kg of heroin, 38 tons

of poppy husk, 810 kg of opium, 968 kg of ganja, 90 kg of charas, 5 kg of cocaine, 59 kg of ICE, and 55 lakh intoxicating tablets. Targeting cross-border smuggling, police recovered 403 drones and intercepted 527 kg of heroin delivered via drones. The financial backbone of drug networks has also been hit hard. ₹22 crore in drug money was recovered, 96 major hawala operators were arrested, and illegal properties worth ₹327 crore belonging to 822 drug smugglers were frozen. Of 10,696 cases decided so far, 9,509 ended in conviction — an 89% conviction rate, the highest in the country. On the rehabilitation side, 10,463 people caught with small quantities were referred to de-addiction programs, while 37,362 addicts were admitted to de-addiction centres and 1,15,161 to O O A T centres for treatment.

Gangstran Te Vaar: Cracking Down on Organised Crime. Launched January 20, 2026, this intelligence-led operation targets gangster syndicates through inter-

state coordination, financial disruption, and technology-driven policing. "Punjab will not be a safe haven for gangsters and criminals," CM Mann said, stressing that police are working to ensure law-abiding citizens feel secure. Since its launch, police have conducted 89,594 raids and arrested 36,381 people, including 674 gang associates and 35,707 wanted individuals, while bringing 1,196 proclaimed offenders to justice. The campaign has also led to the recovery of 677 firearms, 184 sharp-edged weapons, 1,846 rounds of ammunition, and 12 hand grenades. A Coordinated Crackdown: Together, the two campaigns have delivered record-breaking seizures, arrests, and convictions while systematically targeting the financial infrastructure that sustains organised crime. Officials say the dual approach — combining aggressive enforcement with rehabilitation efforts — reflects the state's broader push toward becoming a safer, drug-free Punjab.

EDUCATION

Punjab's "Shikhya Kranti": A Government School Revolution

Bhagwant Singh Mann led State Government overhauls school system: fee cap, direct books & students shine in national level competitive exams

Punjab's government school system has undergone a dramatic transformation under Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann's "Shikhya Kranti" (Education Revolution), turning once-neglected institutions into competitive, outcome-driven schools delivering some of the best results in the country.

Rising Investment, Rising Results

The state's education budget has grown substantially, from ₹12,657 crore in 2021–22 to ₹19,279 crore in 2026–27, underlining the government's sustained focus on the sector. That investment appears to be paying off: NITI Aayog's 2026 Education Quality Report placed Punjab ahead of Kerala — long regarded as India's benchmark for

school education — on key foundational learning metrics. Punjab posted 82% proficiency in language and 78% in mathematics for Class 3, compared to Kerala's 75% and 70%. In Class 9 mathematics, Punjab scored 52% against Kerala's 45%.

Punjab also topped the Centre's Performance Grading Index (PGI) 2.0 for 2024–25, achieving the Pracheta-I Grade — a distinction shared only with Chandigarh — and surpassing Kerala, Delhi, Maharashtra, and Himachal Pradesh. The state ranked first nationally in the Learning Outcomes & Quality domain, scoring 150.4.

Other indicators reflect this shift: 99.9% of government schools now

have electricity, 99% have functional computers, and over 80% feature smart classrooms. More than 90% of Class 10 students now move on to Class 11, pointing to falling dropout rates, while the student-teacher ratio has improved to 22:1.

Schools of Eminence and Expanded Access

A second phase of the Education Revolution, backed by ₹3,500 crore, is being called the largest education reform program in the state's history. Central to this push are 118 Schools of Eminence, designed to let talented students pursue education suited to their abilities. Free bus services for girls attending these schools and other government institutions now benefit around 15,500 students, ensuring transport

is not a barrier to education.

Since April 2022, the state has recruited 14,525 teachers and regularised the jobs of 12,316 education department employees. Schools have also been staffed with 1,932 campus managers, 1,323 security guards, 7,876 sanitation workers, and 1,792 watchmen to improve maintenance and safety. Punjab is the only state to provide high-speed fiber Wi-Fi across all government schools, which is a ₹20 crore initiative.

Global Training, Local Impact

Teacher and principal training has taken on an international dimension. Eight batches comprising 264 officers, principals, and teachers have trained in Singapore; four batches of 288 primary teachers

studied at the University of Turku in Finland; and five batches sent 243 headmasters to IIM Ahmedabad for leadership training.

Infrastructure upgrades — including science labs, computer labs, kitchens, medical rooms, and separate toilets for boys and girls — have brought many government schools at par with private institutions, giving parents genuine choice. The Business Blaster scheme, meanwhile, has encouraged entrepreneurial thinking among students, who have collectively generated ₹70 crore through their own ventures. Punjab also became the first state to introduce Entrepreneurship as a Class 11 subject.

Stories of Aspiration

Behind the statistics are individual stories of perseverance. Priya Bhardwaj, a student at the School of Eminence in Bhagpur Sataur, Hoshiarpur, was raised by her single mother on an annual income of ₹1.44 lakh after her father's death. She cleared JEE Advanced with support from the government's coaching ecosystem and hopes to become an engineer in her late father's memory. Prabjot Singh, from the School of Eminence in Mullanpur, SAS Nagar, comes from a family where his father works as a labourer; he too cleared JEE Advanced, crediting academic support from teachers and his school's encouragement.

Policy Reforms

The state has also moved on

systematic reforms. Following feedback at the "Sitare Zameen Te" felicitation event on May 31, 2026, CM Bhagwant Singh Mann ordered the Punjab School Education Board to scrap its date-of-birth tie-breaker rule, ensuring students with identical marks receive the same rank. Additionally, the government is drafting legislation to curb arbitrary fee hikes by private schools, aiming to protect over 32 lakh students and their families. The proposed law would cap annual fee increases at 5% and require schools

that raised fees beyond 15% over three years to refund the excess to parents — part of a broader push to



reshape how school education is delivered across the state.

Advertisement

INBRIEF



CM gives appointment orders to over 400 TNPSC recruits

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Wednesday handed over appointment orders to 383 Assistant Engineers and 18 Assistant Accounts Officers, who were recently recruited by the Tamil Nadu Public Service Commission (TNPSC). Minister R. Nirmalkumar, Chief Secretary M. Sai Kumar, Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Limited Chairman and Managing Director J. Radhakrishnan, Energy Secretary Anil Meshram, and other officials took part in the event at Kalaivanar Arangam in Chennai.



‘Constitution Murder Day’ to be observed by BJP today

The Tamil Nadu unit of the BJP is planning to observe ‘Constitution Murder Day’ on June 25 to mark the declaration of a nationwide Emergency imposed on June 25, 1975, by then Prime Minister Indira Gandhi. BJP State president Nainar Nagenthiran has constituted a committee under senior party leader Pon. Radhakrishnan to coordinate the arrangements.

Symbolism or substance? Public health professionals question gold ring scheme

Giving gold rings to newborns may be intended as a celebration of birth, but the more pressing need is investment in workforce and infrastructure that makes safe deliveries possible, say health officials and doctors. State govt. will spend ₹755.83 crore annually on gifting gold rings to newborns

Serena Josephine M.
CHENNAI

Every year, the State government will spend ₹755.83 crore on gifting one-gram gold rings to roughly 4.42 lakh babies born in government hospitals under its new scheme, *Thaimaaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam*. The gold ring may be intended as a celebration of birth, but for many within the public health sector, the more pressing need is investment in the workforce and infrastructure that makes safe deliveries possible.

Already, the Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy Maternity Benefit Scheme provides maternal assistance of ₹14,000 in cash support and two nutritional kits valued at ₹4,000. With this in place, the questions raised are plenty – Can the State government sustain a recurring cost of ₹755.83 crore a year, or ₹17,000 per ring (today’s gold rate), for 4,41,667 deliveries along with administration cost? Whether symbolic incentives such as gold rings are the best use of public resources when basic gaps in the health system remain unresolved? Does this self-defeat the State’s family

Nurturing newborns

A look at the salient features of the *Thaimaaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam*

GOALS AND OBJECTIVES

■ Elevate the public healthcare setting from a baseline necessity to a preferred destination of pride and celebration, with dignity at birth

■ Reclaim the status of government institutional deliveries by offering a high-value, permanent, tangible benefit that complements the existing maternity cash benefits and maternal kits

■ Erase the socio-economic bias surrounding public health facility deliveries, recognising that every mother’s journey is noble and every child is a treasure



TARGET BENEFICIARIES AND ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

■ Resident of Tamil Nadu

■ All pregnant women giving birth at government institutions

■ Mother should be registered on Pregnancy and Infant Cohort Monitoring and Evaluation portal with RCH ID

■ Beneficiaries must submit residential proof through any one of the enlisted documents such as ration card, voter identity card or Aadhaar card

■ The scheme extends coverage to all newborns, regardless of birth order. Mothers with higher-order births are eligible for benefits without restriction

■ Gold rings to be distributed without any gender-based discrimination

KEY SPECIFICATIONS

■ One-gram gold rings will be procured through the Tamil Nadu Medical Services Corporation (TNMSC). The TNMSC-empowered vendor will supply the rings directly to 94 hospitals

■ A State project/programme management unit will be set up to implement, monitor, and manage the scheme

■ Each gold ring will have a fixed weight of one gram, with an official Bureau of Indian Standards hallmark. The Government of Tamil Nadu logo will be embossed on it

■ Each unit will be uniquely serialised and protected by a tamper-proof seal with branding

Source: Government Order issued by the Health and Family Welfare Department

welfare measures by incentivising higher order births?

A head of a government institution found it bizarre that the Tamil Nadu Medical Services Corporation (TNMSC) is tasked with

procuring and supplying the rings, based on the yearly indent given by the Director of Public Health and Preventive Medicine.

“TNMSC was set up in the 1990s with the objective of procuring quality

medicines for government hospitals. But now, it is tasked with purchasing the yellow metal. How far this is ethical is a question to be asked,” he said.

A health officer said that from a policy per-

spective, the scheme had no connection with the Sustainable Development Goal 3 (reducing global Maternal Mortality Ratio to less than 70 deaths per 1,00,000 live births and to end preventable deaths of newborns and children under five years of age by 2030).

Another public health officer said Tamil Nadu had already achieved near-universal institutional delivery coverage, with institutional deliveries exceeding 99%, leaving limited scope for further improvement on this indicator. “A government’s legitimacy comes from good governance, not symbolic kinship. Public resources should be directed towards strengthening systems and services that create lasting benefits,” he said.

While more incentives are being introduced, many frontline healthcare personnel continue to face inadequate remuneration, he said, adding that Reproductive and Child Health contract staff receive approximately ₹4,500 per month. “There is an acute shortage of obstetricians and gynaecologists. The government should announce funds to hire more OB-GYNs as and

when they announce such schemes,” a doctor said.

‘Self-defeating’
“This scheme covers all newborns, irrespective of the third or fourth child. Isn’t this defeating the government’s own family welfare programme? On the one hand, we are motivating mothers to undergo sterilisation after having two babies, and on the other, the government is giving incentives to have any number of babies,” she said.

The doctor said certain conditions can be brought in for the scheme, including two mandatory post-natal visits for mothers at the end of the first week and the sixth week of delivery, and complete immunisation till 1.5 years of age for the child.

Former Director of Public Health and Preventive Medicine K. Kolasandamy said it was a good scheme as it would improve institutional deliveries.

The scheme could act as an incentive for families belonging to the lower-middle income group to opt for government hospitals for childbirth, thereby reducing their maternal and childbirth-related health expenditure in private hospitals, he said.

Video showing Higher Education Minister touching girl athletes’ legs sparks outrage

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A video showing Higher Education Minister P. Viswanathan touching the outstretched legs of girl athletes while chatting with them at an event in Melur in Madurai recently has sparked outrage.

The athletes were resting after having run a marathon organised as part of the birthday celebrations of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay and Congress leader Rahul Gandhi. After distributing prizes at the Melur Government School, where the event was held, the Minister greeted the athletes. The video captures him touching the outstretched legs of the athletes and cracking their toes, while another guest is shaking hands with them.



P. Viswanathan

DMK leader and former Minister S.S. Sivasankar expressed concern over the incident, saying the good-touch bad-touch lesson, which is usually taught to schoolchildren, should be extended to members of the Cabinet.

“A person of authority should act more responsibly rather than getting swept away by the moment or the intoxication of power,” said Vidya Reddy, co-founder, Tulir-Centre for

the Prevention and Healing of Child Sexual Abuse.

She wondered why, despite a large number of people being present at the venue, and with video cameras recording the event, no onlookers had raised their voice.

Reacting to DMK leader Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi, who had strongly criticised him over the incident, Mr. Viswanathan said the DMK will have to “face consequences” if it continues to “spread lies” through its IT wing.

In a statement, Mr. Viswanathan said Mr. Poyyamozhi attributing motives to the act was “uncivilised”.

“On the occasion of the 56th birthday of the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, and the 52nd birthday of

the Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu, C. Joseph Vijay, a public awareness marathon titled ‘ViRa’ (Vijay-Rahul) was organised in Melur, Madurai, against tobacco, alcohol, cannabis, narcotic substances, and sexual crimes against women. Hundreds of students participated in the 4-km event. Due to the intense heat, some participants fainted and collapsed. Acting out of humanitarian concern, I lifted those girls, sprinkled water on them to help them regain consciousness, and provided first aid,” he said.

Complaint lodged

Meanwhile, a complaint was lodged at the DGP’s office against Mr. Viswanathan by lawyer Saranya Natarajan of the DMK’s Legal wing.

Case registered against DMK’s Gen Z wing coordinator over ‘offensive post’

The Hindu Bureau
KRISHNAGIRI

The Krishnagiri police are on the lookout for the DMK’s Gen Z wing coordinator, Anbanandan Ariyappan, in connection with a post on Instagram that purportedly “outraged the modesty of women” and “defamed the government”.

The Rayakottai police registered a case against Mr. Anbanandan based on a complaint lodged by the TVK East Union secretary (Kelamangalam), Moorthy, over the post that was published on Tuesday.

Mr. Anbanandan’s post proclaimed to be a response to Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay’s “kutty story” in his Assembly speech on Tuesday, where he took a swipe at the Leader of

the Opposition, Udhayanidhi Stalin, by asking him about the whereabouts of his father, DMK leader, and former Chief Minister M.K. Stalin.

Mr. Anbanandan’s post showed him pretending to be on a phone call with Mr. Vijay’s son, asking him about the whereabouts of his father, and goes on to make certain statements about the Chief Ministers’ relationships.

The post was published at 4.30 p.m, and the FIR was filed soon after. The police landed at the house of Anbanandan after 10.30 p.m. for an inquiry.

Superintendent of Police G.S. Anitha told *The Hindu* that there was no political pressure to act, but since the case involved “outraging the modesty of women”, and given the go-

vernment’s position on crimes against women, the police filed the case.

A search was on for Anbanandan, and he will be arrested, Ms. Anitha said.

DMK leader Kanimozhi Karunanidhi criticised the search at Anbanandan’s house, and challenged the government to crack down on the youth raising their voice against the government.

“A late-night search at a home for a social media post creates a fear psychosis and self-censorship. The social media surveillance, purportedly to protect the dignity of women, is selective, excluding many others from its protections,” said Aadhavan Deetchanya, the Communist writer and general secretary, Tamil Nadu Progressive Writers and

Artists Association.

Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin also condemned the attempt to arrest Mr. Anbanandan.

He further claimed that members of the TVK had assaulted a person named Kani in Saidapet, Chennai, who had recently spoken at a Gen Z meeting organised by the DMK.

“The police, who have not registered any case against the perpetrators of the assault, intimidated Kani while he was in hospital for treatment, and forced him to get discharged. Is this the ‘change’ you promised – sending the police if anyone speaks against the ruling party and the government, but being a mute spectator if the attackers belong to the TVK,” he asked.

Ammonia gas leak toll rises to 10 as one more dies

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The death toll in the ammonia gas leak at a seafood processing and export facility in Tiruvallur district rose to 10 on Wednesday, with the death of another worker from Odisha.

According to a media bulletin issued by the Tamil Nadu Health Department, the victim was identified as Subasi Juanga.

A total of 83 individuals were reported to be affected by the incident that occurred on June 21. Of them, 68 individuals are under treatment, including 65 women and three men.

Seventeen patients are on ventilator support, 21 are receiving nasal oxygen, and 30 are stable. Five persons have been discharged after treatment.

Former engineer pitches Rasimanal as an alternative site to Mekedatu for dam project

T. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

A former engineer from Tamil Nadu has mooted a proposal to build a dam in Rasimanal in Krishnagiri district as an alternative to the contentious Mekedatu drinking water-cum-balancing reservoir project.

Envisaged with a capacity of 66 thousand million cubic feet (tmc ft), the proposed dam will be upstream of the Mettur dam in Salem district. It can generate 360 megawatt (MW) of electricity, and its operation can be handled by the Water Resources Department of Tamil Nadu. The total area of submergence will be around 106 sq. km, about a third of which will lie in Karnataka.

“Apart from being a perfect alternative to the Mekedatu project, the Rasi-



The Rasimanal dam will cater to the drinking water requirements of Bengaluru, while addressing concerns about the availability of water for Cauvery delta farmers, says the expert. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

manal project will bring about a win-win situation for both States, as it will cater to the drinking water requirements of Bengaluru, while addressing our concerns about the availability of water for our farmers in the Cauvery delta,” says A. Stephen, former Chief Engineer in the now-abolished Tamil Nadu Generation and Distribution

Corporation (Tangedco) and the Tamil Nadu Electricity Board (TNEB).

Giving one more reason why Rasimanal, and not Mekedatu, should be preferred, the former Chief Engineer explains that the submersible area for the Mekedatu project falls under the Cauvery wildlife sanctuary with numerous elephant corridors. “It is



The Rasimanal project will bring about a win-win situation for both States [Tamil Nadu and Karnataka]

A. STEPHEN
Former Chief Engineer, Tangedco

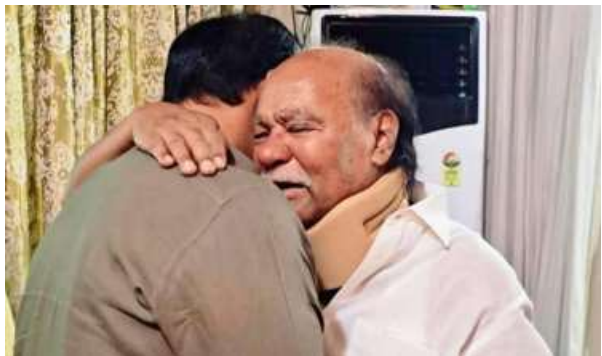
extremely difficult to get environmental and forest clearance from the Union Ministry of Environment, Forest, and Climate Change,” he says, wondering why Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar has been giving an impression that the Mekedatu project will take off swiftly.

P.R. Pandian, a farmer-leader of the Cauvery delta, has been a strong votary of the Rasimanal dam project.

As a senior government

official, Mr. Stephen took part in several meetings convened by the Union Power Ministry during 2000-2010 to arrive at a consensus among the States of the Cauvery basin on hydropower projects. He recalls that the National Hydro Power Corporation (NHPC), a Central agency, had even identified the site in Rasimanal. In addition to this plant, the NHPC’s plan covered one more plant in Tamil Nadu – Hogenakkal (120 MW) and two plants in Karnataka – Shivasamudram (345 MW) and Mekedatu (400 MW).

The veteran engineer, who addressed a letter to Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay a few weeks ago, giving a brief outline of the project, suggests that the proposed dam be built as a joint venture of the two basin States.



Mending ties: Anbumani Ramadoss hugs his father S. Ramadoss at the family’s Thailapuram residence on Wednesday.

Anbumani calls on his father Ramadoss

The Hindu Bureau
VILLUPURAM

Amid the ongoing feud within the PMK, party president Anbumani Ramadoss on Wednesday called on his father and party founder S. Ramadoss at the family’s Thailapuram residence in Villupuram district.

Dr. Anbumani, accompanied by his wife and

Dharmapuri MLA Sowmya Anbumani and other family members, visited his parents on the occasion of their 61st wedding anniversary.

Speaking to reporters, Dr. Anbumani said he had come to seek his parents’ blessings. When asked whether their differences had been resolved, he said, “Good things would happen now.”

INBRIEF



Don't be negligent towards SIR, Revanth tells leaders

Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy has directed Ministers and senior Congress leaders, including MLAs and MPs, to be cautious about the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls – starting on Thursday, warning that it is a serious subject. Participating in a zoom meeting with party leaders on Wednesday, he found fault with some leaders for their negligent attitude towards the exercise. Poor people will lose voting rights, he said and called for awareness drives.

IIM Bangalore retains top Pioneering School status

In the 2026 edition of the Positive Impact Rating (PIR) for Business Schools, a global student-led assessment of societal impact, the Indian Institute of Management Bangalore (IIMB) earned an overall score of 9.7, substantially higher than the global average of 8.0. It was also designated a Level 5 Pioneering School for the fifth year, the highest category within the PIR framework. PIR is governed by a Swiss association and was initiated by a coalition of business school experts.

Karnataka's online govt. services likely to be hit today

A number of people-centric online services of the Karnataka government will be affected on Thursday, as major upgrades are being taken up at the State Data Centre that hosts many government sites. The services will be hit from 9 p.m. and the shutdown is expected to last 24 hours. The centre hosts about 69 departments/ corporations of the State government. They offer online services, including Aadhaar-related tasks, traffic challans, and issue of certificates.

Kerala Left parties lock horns with Cong. govt. over PM SHRI

Each side accuses the other of 'surrendering to Sangh Parivar agenda'; Minister says a committee is studying the scheme; Opposition walks out of Assembly after Speaker rejects plea for discussion

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Opposition Left Democratic Front (LDF) and the ruling Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) on Wednesday locked horns in the Kerala Assembly over the implementation of the Centrally funded PM SHRI (Prime Minister Schools for Rising India) scheme in the State. Each side accused the other of “surrendering to the Sangh Parivar agenda”.

The Opposition said that although the previous LDF government had signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with the Centre for the implementa-



The Kerala Assembly saw heated discussions on Wednesday on the Centrally funded school development scheme.

tion of the scheme in Kerala in October 2025, the government withdrew from the scheme within just 20 days after requesting the Centre to keep the MoU in abeyance, considering the larger interests of the State, said Leader of the Opposi-

tion Pinarayi Vijayan.

The present ruling front, which was in the Opposition at that time and had claimed that it would “throw PM SHRI into the Arabian Sea if it came to power,” is now pursuing the project without any

shame, Mr. Vijayan added.

However, rejecting the Opposition's allegations, General Education Minister N. Samsudheen said the UDF had not taken any stance on the issue. The government has only appointed a Cabinet sub-committee to study the scheme, he said.

After his reply, Speaker Thiruvanchoor Radhakrishnan rejected the Opposition's demand to adjourn all other business to discuss the issue. The LDF members then staged a walkout.

The PM SHRI is aimed at developing select schools as model institutions in line with the National Education Policy, 2020.

BJP councillors retake oath after court order

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Kerala High Court on Wednesday directed 20 BJP councillors of the Thiruvananthapuram Municipal Corporation to retake their oaths in the name of God or by making a solemn affirmation. They had earlier taken oath in the name of local deities, Bharath Matha, and “Balidaanis” (martyrs in RSS parlance). The order came on a petition filed by Left Demo-

cratic Front Council Party leader in the corporation, S.P. Deepak.

Justice P.V. Kunhikrishnan held that the councillors' original oaths were invalid as per the Kerala Municipality Act, 1994.

After the order, an oath-taking ceremony was held and 19 councillors took oath. One councillor is in jail. A Congress ward member of the Vadakkanchery grama panchayat in Palakkad was also directed to retake oath.

₹405-cr. gold mining facility opens in A.P.

K. Umashanker
KURNOOL

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu inaugurated the first unit of a gold mining project at Jonnagiri in Kurnool district on Wednesday.

The ₹405-crore plant was established by Geomysore Services India Pvt. Limited (GMSI). Mr. Naidu also laid the foundation stone for the second unit.

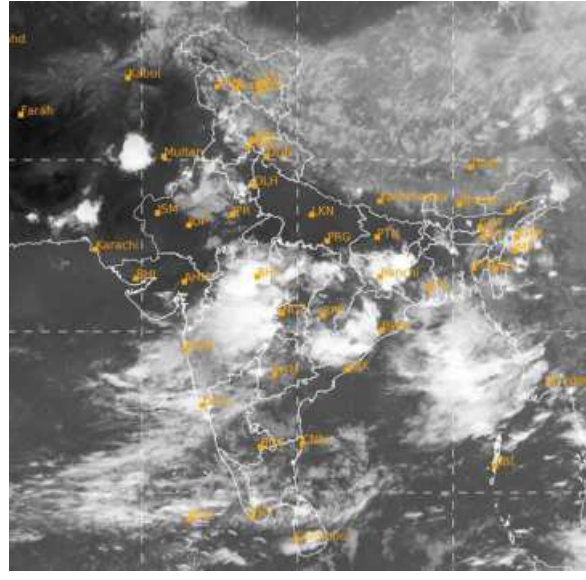
Marking the commencement of sales, he then

handed over gold produced at the unit to jewellery firms in the State.

Addressing a public meeting later, the Chief Minister said: “Jonnagiri, once known as Suvarnagiri, will emerge as a model growth centre for Andhra Pradesh.” Karnataka's Kolar Gold Fields (KGF) had once dominated the national scene, but now “Jonnagiri unit is the cynosure of all eyes”. “The plant will have an annual capacity of 400 kg of gold,” he said.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: AQICN/CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Thursday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, West Bengal, Odisha, Jharkhand, Telangana, Maharashtra, Konkarn & Goa and Karnataka. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Kerala and Lakshadweep

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala		33.3	26.5	Kurnool		36.1	26.3
Ahmedabad		40.4	29.2	Lucknow		40.4	28.0
Aizawl	115.8	28.6	21.2	Madurai		39.0	28.0
Bengaluru		30.4	21.2	Mangaluru	12	30.4	22.0
Bhopal		34.6	24.4	Mumbai	22.5	27.7	22.4
Bhubaneswar		37.8	27.0	Mysuru		30.2	20.2
Chandigarh		39.8	26.1	New Delhi	8	39.3	26.6
Chennai		36.7	29.0	Patna		40.6	27.2
Coimbatore		31.4	22.5	Port Blair	3	31.4	26.6
Dehradun		34.7	23.8	Prayagraj		43.4	28.8
Gangtok		28	17.2	Puducherry		37.6	29.0
Goa	39	28.4	23.8	Pune	38.4	29.9	22.0
Guwahati	3	34.6	26.6	Raipur	6	37.0	25.5
Hubballi		28.0	23.0	Ranchi		34.4	24.4
Hyderabad		32.4	24.5	Shillong	4	26.3	15.9
Imphal		32.0	22.7	Shimla		27.8	20.2
Jaipur		38.9	27.6	Srinagar		32.0	16.2
Kochi	2	29.8	25.4	Thiruvananthapuram	0.4	33.4	24.5
Kohima		24.0	19.0	Tiruchirappalli		36.7	27.0
Kolkata	17	32.8	25.3	Vijayawada		37.0	27.0
Kozhikode	4	32.6	24.8	Visakhapatnam		34.2	28.3

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad							In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Sonipat.
Bengaluru							Haryana recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 295
Chennai							indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Aizawl, Mizoram recorded a healthy AQI score of 14
Delhi							
Hyderabad							
Kolkata							
Lucknow							
Mumbai							
Pune							
Visakhapatnam							

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)
SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.
NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.
CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.
PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
MATERIALS MANAGEMENT DEPARTMENT
ADDENDUM TO AUCTION PROGRAMME JUNE '26
NOTICE No: 06/2026
e-Auction will be conducted for disposal of Ferrous scrap, Non-Ferrous scrap, other Misc scrap, condemned Wagon, Coaches & Locos, Scrap Rails and other Permanent Way scrap materials.

e-Auction Conducted by	Additional Auction dates are included in JUNE '26 auction schedule and which are given below	Material for auction
Sr. DMM / SA	30/06/2026	The details of items to be sold in e-auction will be available in catalogue www.ireps.gov.in website

Note: All other auctions scheduled for JUNE '26 remains unaltered

For detailed terms and conditions and downloading of catalogue please visit our website <https://www.ireps.gov.in> -> E-Auction -> Sale -> Live Auctions.

Principal Chief Materials Manager

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
COMMERCIAL BRANCH
NOTIFICATION No. 01/2026
EMPAANELMENT OF DIGITAL AGGREGATOR PLATFORMS TO SUPPLY FOOD AND OTHER EVERYDAY ESSENTIALS OVER SOUTHERN RAILWAY.
Applications, under "Expression of Interest" - (EOI) are invited from reputed Food Delivery Aggregators, E-Commerce Platforms, Quick Commerce Service Providers and other Digital Marketplace Operators for providing food and other essentials/ everyday products to railway passengers over Southern Railway.
The application can be downloaded from www.sr.indianrailways.gov.in or obtained from the Office of the Principal Chief Commercial Manager, Southern Railway, Chennai - 600003 on working days 24.06.2026 to 13.07.2026 between 11.00 hrs and 16.00 hrs.
PRE-EOI CONSULTATION MEETING: 07.07.2026 at 11:00 hrs at the above office.
Filed-in applications should be submitted on or before 16.00 hrs on 14.07.2026 at the above address or to email: dycmps@sr.railnet.gov.in.
Chief Commercial Manager (Passenger Services & Catering)

TOURISM CORPORATION OF GUJARAT LIMITED (TCGL)
(A Government of Gujarat undertaking)
Udyog Bhavan, Block No. 16, 4th Floor, Sector - 11, Gandhinagar - 382 011
Website: <https://www.gujarattourism.com>
TENDER NOTICE
Bids are invited from reputed and experienced agencies for "Infrastructure Assessment for Destination Wedding Tourism Development in Gujarat".
The project requirements, technical specifications, eligibility criteria, selection process, etc. are included in the Tender documents, which shall be available for download from the websites: <https://tender.nprocure.com/>, and <https://www.gujarattourism.com> from 25/06/2026 onwards.
The last date for submission of the Technical and Financial Bid (online only) is 16/07/2026 up to 6:00 pm, and Technical Bid (physical only) is 18/07/2026 up to 3:00 pm.
Managing Director

BENGALURU EAST CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer, Whitefield Division, Beside Govt Polytechnic, Immadihalli, Bengaluru - 560066
No.: BECC/EE/WF/TN/01/2026-27 **Date: 23.06.2026**
INVITATION FOR TENDERS (Short Term)
(Only Through KPP Portal)
The Executive Engineer, Whitefield Division invites Item Rate tenders from eligible tenderers for the work details in the table given below. The bidders shall be a registered in CPWD / KPWD / Railways / MES any State or Central Govt. Organization.

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1	Comprehensive Development of Roads and Drains and other allied works in Ward No. 40-Vanthur, 50- Gunjur, 39-Hagadur, 38- Whitefield, 33- SM Krishna in Whitefield Division of Mahadevapura Constituency. (Annexure-2, Sl. No. 33 to 41). Amount put to tender (In Lakhs): 980.00, EMD (In Rs.): 14,70,000/-.

Calendar of Events: (1) Tender documents may be downloaded from Government of Karnataka e-procurement website <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>. (2) Last date of submission queries: **30.06.2026** within 3:00 p.m. (3) Date & time for prebid meeting: **30.06.2026 at 4:00 p.m.** (4) Last date & time for receipt of tenders: **04.07.2026 upto 4:00 p.m.** (5) Date & time for opening Technical bid: **06.07.2026 at 4:30 p.m.** (6) Date & time for opening Financial bid: **07.07.2026 at 4:00 p.m.** Further details may be obtained from the above office during office hours or website <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>
Sd/- Executive Engineer, Whitefield Division, Bengaluru East City Corporation

BENGALURU EAST CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer, Doddanekkundi Division, opposite to Phoenix mall, RHB Colony, Whitefield main road, Bengaluru - 560 048
No.BECC/EE/DNK/TN/01/2026-27 **Dated: 23-06-2026**
INVITATION FOR TENDERS (Short Term)
(Through kpp.Portal only)
The Executive Engineer, Doddanekkundi Division invites Item Rate tenders from eligible tenderers for the work details in the table given below. The Bidders shall be a registered in CPWD/KPWD /Railways/MES/ any State or Central Govt. organization. Tender documents may be downloaded from Government of Karnataka e-Procurement website <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in/eportal/index.seam> under login for Contractors:

Sl. No.	Name of the Work/Amount put to tender in lakhs / EMD amount in Rs./Period of Completion
1	Comprehensive Development of Roads and Drains and other allied works in ward no. 43-Doddanekkundi, 42-Priyadarshini, 44-Ashwathnagar, 37-Kundalahalli, 36-Bharath Aikya, 35-Garudacharpalya in Doddanekkundi Division of Mahadevapura Constituency. (Annexure-2, Sl.No.21 to 26). Amount put to Tender : Rs.980.00 Lakhs , EMD (in Rupees): Rs.14,70,000/- . Period of Completion : 09 Months.

Calendar of events:
1. Last date of submission queries : **30-06-2026 within 3.00 P.M**
2. Date & time for Pre Bid Meeting : **30-06-2026 at 4.00 P.M**
3. Last Date & Time for receipt of tenders : **04-07-2026 Upto 4:00 P.M.**
4. Date & Time for Opening Technical bid : **06-07-2026 at 4.30 P.M**
5. Date & Time for Opening Financial bid : **07-07-2026 at 4.00 P.M**
6. Validity of Tenders : **180 Days**
Bid document may be referred for other terms and conditions and any Corrigendum/Addendum will be published & notified only through <http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> or Contact KPP Portal.
Sd/- Executive Engineer, Doddanekkundi Division, BECC

INDIAN INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE
Bangalore - 560012.
Advertisement for the post of Instructor, Teaching Assistant and System Administrator
Applications are invited for the positions of **Instructor, Teaching Assistant and System Administrator** (On Contract) in the Undergraduate Programme at the Institute.
For further details and to apply online, please visit the website <https://iisc.ac.in/careers/contractual-positions/>
Last date of Application – **10.07.2026**
Date: 22.06.2026 **Sd/- REGISTRAR**

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
Chennai Division
Tender No. M-TRD-29-I-OT-25-26-26R3, 28R3 Dated: 22.06.2026
Tender No. M-TRD-29-I-OT-2026-27-03R, 6R2 Dated: 22.06.2026
For and on behalf of the President of India, the Divisional Railway Manager / Traction Distribution Branch, Chennai Division, Southern Railway, Chennai - 3, invites online tender from the experienced Contractors for the following works. For further details, please refer to www.ireps.gov.in

Sl. No.	Tender No. / Name of the Works	Value (₹)	Closing Date / Time
	Tender No. M-TRD-29-I-OT-25-26-26R3		
1	Modification to existing OHE arrangements in connection with Provision of up loop line at Kettandapatti (KDY) in AJJ - JTJ section of Chennai Division.	8598670.30	13.07.2026 at 15.00 hrs
	Tender No. M-TRD-29-I-OT-25-26-28R3		
2	Replacement of existing 65 sq.mmm weak catenary wire in MAS-RU and AJJ - JTJ section of Chennai Division.	23014130.00	13.07.2026 at 15.00 hrs
	Tender No. M-TRD-29-I-OT-2026-27-03R		
3	Modification to existing OHE arrangements in connection with Provision of FOB under Amrit Bharat station Scheme in Chennai Division	7029612.62	13.07.2026 at 15.00 hrs
	Tender No. M-TRD-29-I-OT-2026-27-6R2		
4	Improvements to existing OHE by elimination of silver brazed / codal life completed contact wire on condition basis in non-suburban sections of Chennai Division	29438631.00	13.07.2026 at 15.00 hrs

Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer / Traction Distribution Branch, Chennai - 3

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
Tender Notice No. T-MD-52-COL-TJ, Dated: 22.06.2026
Bid Number: GEM/2026/B/7696484, Dated: 22.06.2026
Chief Medical Superintendent, Railway Hospital, Golden Rock, Tiruchirappalli - 620 004, invites e-tender for the following work.

Sl.No.	Name of the work
1	Activity based contract for outsourcing of housekeeping activities of Thanjavur (TJ) Railway Colony including door-to-door collection of biodegradable and non-biodegradable waste, transportation, segregation, processing of biodegradable waste to compost and handling over of non-biodegradable waste to authorized recyclers for a period of two years (excluding Sundays).
2	Approximate Cost of the work (₹)
3	Earnest Money to be deposited
4	Completion period of the work
5	Date & Time of opening of Bid (Technical Bid)
6	Date & Time of opening of Financial Bid
7	Validity of Bid
8	Website Particulars

Tender Document with detailed terms and conditions are available at the above website.
Chief Medical Superintendent, Railway Hospital, Golden Rock
For and on behalf of the President of India

MAHATRANSCO
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.
NOTICE INVITING TENDER CPD/30-2026-27
Tenders are invited through e-Tendering in SRM Two Bid system from the registered vendors for Supply of following:

Tender No. & Description of Material	Estimated Amount (in Rs. Lakhs)	Due Date & Time (Hrs.) Submission & Opening of Tender
SP/T-0625/0626 RFx 7000040411 (3rd Call) (Two Bid System) for Selection of Solar Power Developers for setting up of 15 MW Grid-Connected Rooftop Solar PV Projects under RESCO Mode at various EHV Substations and Admin Buildings of MSETCL across Maharashtra.	Rs.25459.20 Lakhs	15.07.2026 17:00 Hrs
	Rs. 25,000/-	15.07.2026 17.15 Hrs

Contact Person: Office of the Executive Engineer (VI) CPA, C.O. MSETCL, 1st Floor, Prakashgad Building, Bandra (E), Mumbai
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Email id: cecpa@mahatransco.in, secpa@mahatransco.in, eegrp6@mahatransco.in, eeepc@mahatransco.in, dyeegrp6@mahatransco.in
For further details visit our website <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/>
Any further amendments/clarifications will be published on the MSETCL website www.mahatransco.in & <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/>
Bidders are therefore requested to check these websites for further updates.
Sd/- Executive Engineer (P&C)



Viksit and Surakshit

The cost of inaction on safety issues is more than that of enforcement

The Lucknow fire, which killed 15 people, mostly students, and injured five others, captures both the promise and the perils of aspirational India. It reflects a booming education economy built around a growing services sector, but also the unplanned urban growth and regulatory failures that often accompany it. India's young population, eager to acquire skills and improve economic prospects, has fuelled an ecosystem of coaching centres and training institutes, many of which operate outside formal regulatory frameworks, require low capital investment and generate high profits. As advances in artificial intelligence threaten to reshape employment patterns and formal educational institutions struggle to keep pace with skill requirements, such centres are likely to proliferate. The three-storey building where the fire occurred was reportedly not authorised for commercial use, yet it escaped demolition despite repeated notices. According to the FIR by the civic authorities, neither the owners nor the businesses operating there had made adequate provisions for fire safety. Such violations are common across India, where commercial and educational establishments have little regard for basic safety norms.

The Lucknow incident is also part of a disturbing pattern. This summer has witnessed a succession of major fire accidents across the country. Public attention usually focuses on administrative negligence, and official explanations frequently end with the phrase “electrical fire” – a description that often conceals more than it reveals. Electrical fires can arise from several identifiable causes, including overloaded circuits caused by growing use of appliances, harmonic currents generated by sophisticated equipment that create localised hotspots, poor-quality wiring, and the absence of arc-fault protection devices. Understanding these causes is key to preventing similar tragedies. This requires a stronger culture of investigation. India suffers from inadequate firefighting infrastructure and a shortage of trained fire-forensics experts capable of conducting rigorous root-cause analyses and recommending systemic remedies. Without such expertise, lessons from each disaster remain limited. The challenge therefore demands a national response. India's ambition of becoming a developed nation cannot be separated from the imperative of ensuring public safety. Yet, many buildings lack mandatory fire detection and suppression systems that are standard in developed countries. A Viksit Bharat must also be a Surakshit Bharat. A nationwide assessment of building safety, even through a scientifically designed sample survey, would provide valuable data for reform. The task may be large, but the human and economic costs of inaction are far greater.

Razor's edge

High heat and low rainfall is threatening agricultural produce

The southwest monsoon deficit nationwide has increased from 35% to 43%; the winds' northward advance was stalled near Mumbai; and both the U.S. NOAA and the India Meteorological Department (IMD) expect a moderate-to-strong El Niño this year. The El Niño suppresses the vertical air movement needed for rainclouds to form while a warming Pacific is weakening the trade winds that bring moisture to the subcontinent. The Madden-Julian Oscillation is also in an unfavourable phase and the Indian Ocean Dipole currently cannot offer a buffer. Further, while northwest India has received 5% more rain than normal, central India and the northeast face deficits of 63% and 43%, respectively. But with two-thirds of the seasonal rainfall historically arriving in July and August, the monsoon may still recover and salvage the season. Together with reservoir storage at 30.4% of capacity, compared with 25.1% during previous El Niño years, there is no reason for alarm yet. However, the effects for agriculture are more concerning. The Agriculture Ministry has already prioritised 111 districts out of 315 vulnerable ones based on their irrigation coverage. Extreme heat has been reducing farm labour productivity. High heat and rain shortfall have sown anxiety over the cardamom harvest in Idukki, a fate that bodes ill for other plantation crops in the Western Ghats.

Both the *kharif* sowing window for rice, pulses, and oilseeds and the availability of fertilizers could come under pressure, the latter due to Chinese export curbs and tensions in West Asia, heightening the risks of lower soil moisture and higher input stress. Retail food inflation was 4.2% in April; further deficits will especially threaten vegetables and pulses, complicating the monetary policy. The fundamental problem is the way India has built its rural economy around the assumption of reliable rainfall delivery. No adaptation strategy can indefinitely outpace unchecked warming, so limiting future warming should amount to reducing the extent of exposure. The ideal sustainable strategies are to switch from rain-centric to water-centric organisation, reduce dependence on water-intensive crops, and improve resilience. Pathways for the first two have already been outlined. On the last, while the Agriculture Ministry's extant contingency plans reflect the need for adjustable sowing windows and alternative seed varieties, the principal variable remains implementation at scale. Second, the government should consider a new authority to coordinate inter-State water use and cropping changes based on extended El Niño forecasts, eliminating the cropping governance currently fragmented between the Agriculture and Jal Shakti Ministries, and the IMD.

The decision by the United States military to change the name of its naval command in the region from “US INDOPACOM” to “US PACOM” – United States Indo-Pacific Command to United States Pacific Command – reverting to its original name that was changed in 2018 can be dismissed as superficial, even trivial. Many have already responded with the Shakespearean “What's in a name?”, even as the U.S. Department of War pointed out that US PACOM's area of responsibility, from “the waters off the West Coast of the United States to the western border of India” or what had once been described as “Hollywood to Bollywood, from polar bears to penguins”, has never changed. In 2018, U.S. Defence Secretary Jim Mattis said that the name INDOPACOM was a recognition of the “growing significance” of the Indian Ocean, the Indian subcontinent, and India itself, and the U.S. dropped the term “Asia-Pacific” to “Indo-Pacific”.

Current U.S. Secretary of War Pete Hegseth gave the signal, on May 30, that this understanding has now changed, at his speech at the annual Shangri-La Dialogue in Singapore – compared to more than 30 references to the “Indo-Pacific” in his speech in 2025, his speech this year contained not a single reference to the Indo-Pacific region or strategy.

Given the centre stage that the U.S.'s Indo-Pacific policy has had in India's strategic calculus since 2018, it is necessary, therefore, to go beyond the superficial to the subterranean or submarine, in this case. New Delhi must study how broader trends in U.S. policy are attempting to recast both the region and India's position within it in terms of three broader geographies.

U.S.-China ties and the Quad

The first, is the U.S.'s outreach to China, and concurrently diminishing salience of the Quad (India, Japan Australia, the U.S.), which Beijing has always protested as an “exclusive clique” or derisively as “ocean foam”. In the long term, the U.S. and China cannot shy away from the fierce rivalry between them, but it is clear that in the immediate term, Trump 2.0 has decided to play nice.

U.S. President Donald Trump's visit to Beijing in May 2026 and Chinese President Xi Jinping's upcoming visit to the U.S. on September 24, indicate that the two sides do not want their differences to overcome the relationship, and the U.S. is tiptoeing around the Taiwan issue. Mr. Trump's references to a “G-2”, including during a press availability with Mr. Modi on the sidelines of the 52nd G-7 summit in France (June 15 to 17), are an early warning of a plan to recast the world into “spheres of influence”, where China would be the predominant power in the continent, not as one pole in a multipolar Asia, as India envisions.

As a result, the Quad, rebuilt in Trump 1.0 as a



Suhasini Haidar

counter to China in the region, appears to be floundering. The U.S.'s National Defense Strategy released in January 2026 does not mention the Quad even once. In terms of substance, the Quad's combined agenda has been pared down to four areas of cooperation – maritime security, economic prosperity, critical and emerging minerals technology and disaster responses. Even within these limited objectives, there have been setbacks, such as over Artificial Intelligence cooperation. Despite Quad countries signing on to Pax Silica, and Critical Minerals Initiative Framework with the U.S., the Trump administration ordered Anthropic to end access to its latest models for all non-Americans. Another question concerns the Quad Summit, which India has unsuccessfully sought to host since January 2024. During U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio's visit to Delhi in May 2026, he offered no firm commitment that Mr. Trump would visit Delhi this year, amid indications that the Quad may be relegated to a Foreign Ministers' level grouping. The U.S. Navy's reported actions involving Iranian ship *IRIS Dena* (March 2006) and recent attacks on three ships in which three Indians were killed underscore maritime security and domain awareness concerns within the Quad framework. In July, when he hosts Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi and travels to Indonesia, Australia and New Zealand, Prime Minister Narendra Modi must discuss alternative maritime coalitions and revive the Australia-India-Japan trilateral.

The U.S.'s reversion from INDOPACOM to PACOM suggests that its regional shifts run deeper than a simple name change

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The second geography of concern is West Asia. The U.S. ceasefire with Iran, after just a few months of a surprisingly badly planned war, is indicative of a general fatigue in Trump 2.0 with U.S. friends and allies in the region. The situation is even more volatile today than it was prior to February 28, especially given the short shrift Israel has received in negotiations with Iran, and Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's defiance over the ceasefire for Lebanon. A closer look at the 14-paragraph “Islamabad MoU” released by Iran reveals several signals for the region. Paragraph four states that the U.S. commits to “remove its forces from the proximity of the Islamic Republic of Iran” within 30 days after the final deal. Paragraph five says that, after the Hormuz Strait is demined, Iran and Oman will define the Strait's future administration in consultation with Persian Gulf littoral states. Paragraph 6 stipulates that the U.S., along with regional allies, will provide at least \$300 billion for Iran's reconstruction. These provisions imply commitments on behalf of the Cooperation Council for the Arab States of the Gulf (GCC) states while giving Iran leverage on key issues – military, connectivity, and economic security. Oman and Qatar are now closer to Iran than

The U.S.-Iran MoU and West Asia

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Clearing the road to timely trauma care in India

On May 26, 2026, the Supreme Court of India delivered a landmark judgment with implications for public health policy. Hearing a writ petition filed by SaveLIFE Foundation in October 2024, a Bench of Justices J.K. Maheshwari and Atul S. Chandurkar, in *SaveLIFE Foundation & Anr. vs Union of India & Ors.*, held that the right to trauma care is an integral part of the right to life under Article 21 of the Constitution. The Court ruled that this right extends from the site of injury to definitive hospital treatment and issued nine binding directions to the Union, States and Union Territories, with implementation timelines ranging from three to six months.

Around 4.67 lakh Indians die every year from injuries such as road crashes, falls, burns, drowning, industrial mishaps, fires and disasters, according to National Crime Records Bureau data. Road crashes alone account for nearly 1.77 lakh deaths. Trauma is the leading cause of death among Indians aged 18-45. The Law Commission (201st Report) has estimated that half of road-crash fatalities could be prevented with timely care, while a 2021 NITI Aayog-AIIMS Emergency and Injury Care Report found that at least 30% of deaths are linked to delays in emergency response. India does not lack policies or guidelines; what it has lacked is a uniform, enforceable trauma-care framework.

What the top court has held

The Bench built on earlier jurisprudence. In *Parmanand Katara vs Union of India* (1989), the Court recognised the duty of doctors to render emergency aid. In *Paschim Banga Khet Mazdoor Samiti vs State of West Bengal* (1996), it read access to emergency care into Article 21. In the present order, Article 21, the Court held, covers the entire chain that connects an injured person to medical care: the bystander, the emergency call, the ambulance, the paramedic, the receiving facility.



Piyush Tewari

The Founder and the CEO of SaveLIFE Foundation, a non-profit committed to saving lives through road safety and trauma care

Judicial oversight may finally realise the constitutional right to trauma care

The framing imposes a positive obligation on the state to build and sustain an integrated trauma response system.

This matters because survival in trauma depends on systems rather than on individual institutions. A well-equipped hospital cannot compensate for a delayed ambulance. An ambulance cannot help if the bystander is afraid to call. A trauma surgeon cannot save a patient who never reaches the hospital in time.

A cooperative federalism approach

Public health, hospitals and ambulance services fall under the State List in the Seventh Schedule, making cooperation between the Union and the States essential for a uniform trauma-care framework. Compliance affidavits and information notes filed by 34 States and Union Territories indicate a willingness to implement Union policies and standardise trauma care. Accepting the Attorney General's submission that the Union should act as an enabler, the Bench called for “sustained and concerted efforts” by both levels of government. The directions do not alter the constitutional division of powers; they provide judicial backing to existing frameworks such as Prime Minister - Road Accident Victims' Hospitalisation and Assured Treatment (PM RAHAT), the National Ambulance Code AIS-125, Emergency Response Support System (ERSS)-112, the emergency medical technician (EMT) curriculum, the Good Samaritan Rules and the Health Ministry's trauma-care guidelines.

The directions fall into five clusters. On communications, all emergency numbers (100, 101, 102, 108, 1033, 1091 and their State variants) must be integrated into helpline 112 within three months, with mass media publicity. On bystander protection, every State must set up physical and digital grievance-redress systems for Good Samaritans, with nodal authorities at the State and district levels. On pre-hospital response, all

before and have been part of the Pakistan-led mediation process, while countries such as Saudi Arabia are seeking new security arrangements with Türkiye, Pakistan, and Ukraine.

India's policy towards the region requires a rapid revision in light of the post-war, post-deal power structure. What was once a finely balanced approach now appears tilted towards Israel and the United Arab Emirates. New Delhi must also urgently reconsider its compliance with U.S. sanctions on Iranian oil and the Chabahar port, given Washington's shifting positions.

The U.S. and South Asia

Finally, India must study the implications of U.S. foreign policy decisions in its neighbourhood. The appointment of Sergio Gor as both U.S. Ambassador to India and Special Envoy for South and Central Asia signals Washington's growing regional ambitions. New Delhi has pushed back on attempts by the U.S. to become a supra entity in South Asia, as well as its efforts to resolve intra-regional conflicts between India and Pakistan. This ambition was hinted at during Operation Sindoor (May 2025), and repeated by Mr. Trump over the past year, especially as he met the Pakistani leadership many times in this period.

Mr. Gor's recent travels to Kathmandu, Thimphu, Dhaka and Colombo indicate that the U.S. is keen to broaden its efforts across the region. In the absence of effective pan-regional frameworks such as the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC) and the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC) – both are constrained by New Delhi's political tensions with Islamabad and Dhaka – it is clear that the U.S. is entering into competition with China for influence in South Asia.

Beijing has already built several mechanisms for cooperation with South Asia, and both powers side-stepping India. India, as chair of the Indian Ocean Rim Association, and with Mr. Modi due to attend the planned BIMSTEC summit in Bangladesh and the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) summit in Pakistan next year, has an opportunity to reassert its regional leadership. Given the opportunities, a revival of the SAARC grouping and other pan-regional initiatives must be considered.

Concerns over the U.S.'s moves across India's geographies may seem contrary to the bonhomie at the Modi-Trump meeting at the G-7 meet in France, and the red carpet for Mr. Rubio's India visit. Shorn of the rhetoric, however, the trends in U.S. policy are clear, and New Delhi must plan accordingly, acknowledging that the shifts run far deeper than the ripples on the surface caused by a dropped prefix.

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LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Chief Minister's speech

It is clear from Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay's maiden speech, laced with 'punch dialogues', in the Tamil Nadu Assembly that he has not yet fully outgrown his passion for acting. His dramatic 'hand movement' may have delighted his fans, but they were out of place on the floor of the august House. A substantial

portion of his speech was devoted to self-praise and DMK-bashing. Mr. Vijay cannot shirk responsibility by claiming that he has inherited long-standing problems and that addressing them will take time. His foremost priorities should be preventing crimes against women and curbing the drug menace in the State. His reference to

the electoral defeat of DMK president M.K. Stalin through a “short story” was also unnecessary. That said, Mr. Vijay deserves credit for giving greater representation to Dalits and women in his Ministry, and for reaffirming his commitment to secularism, social justice and ending illegal mining. **G. David Milton,** Maruthancode, Tamil Nadu

The Chief Minister's gestures and dramatic flourishes, accompanied by gleeful clapping and hooting from the Treasury benches to score political points over the Opposition, resembled a scene from a masala potboiler rather than a legislative debate. Such conduct is an affront to the intelligence of the electorate. Our lawmakers would do well to restore

decorum to the House; only then can governance receive the attention it deserves.

S. Sanjeevi Rao, Puducherry

Hand in the till

It is distressing that the Ram temple is in the limelight for all the wrong reasons, especially since the government has sought to derive political dividends

from its consecration. Reports of alleged embezzlement and pilferage of donations are deeply upsetting for devotees. The perpetrators must be brought to book at the earliest to restore public trust.

Aanya Singhal, Noida, Uttar Pradesh

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Sustaining India's low-fertility future

India is entering a new demographic phase. The latest Sample Registration System data puts the country's total fertility rate at 1.9 children per woman, below both the global average of 2.2 and the replacement level of 2.1 needed to keep a population stable. For a country that has long worried about population growth, this marks an important turn.

However, the decline is not uniform. Rural fertility is still around the replacement mark, while urban fertility has fallen to 1.5. The sharper divide is geographic. Delhi's fertility rate stands at an ultra-low of 1.2, while Kerala, Tamil Nadu and West Bengal are at 1.3. These levels are lower than those in the United States (1.6), Finland (1.4), and Japan (1.3). At the other end, Bihar remains at 2.9, followed by Uttar Pradesh (2.6), Madhya Pradesh (2.4), and Rajasthan (2.3).

The implication is that India has crossed into low fertility as a nation, but not as one demographic economy. While some States are already moving rapidly towards ageing, others still have large cohorts set to enter the labour force over the next two decades. India must create productive opportunities for young workers in poorer and younger States, while strengthening income, care, and health systems for older populations where fertility has already fallen very low.

A difficult shift

The transition could indeed be challenging. Western Europe and Japan aged after they had industrialised, brought a large share of workers into formal employment, widened their tax systems, and built welfare institutions with some capacity for risk-pooling. Even then, ageing strained public finances; Japan saw the burden push public debt above 200% of GDP.

India enters the same demographic passage on a weaker institutional and fiscal base. Its



Amarendu Nandy

Associate Professor, Economics & Public Policy Area, Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Ranchi. Views are personal

per-capita income is around \$2,800. Its direct tax base remains narrow, with net direct taxpayers accounting for only about 6% of the total population. State governments, tasked with much of the social-sector response, are already fiscally stretched.

The labour-market base is just as fragile. Since most workers spend their lives in informal or semi-formal work, old-age income security remains largely outside formal employment contracts. A contribution-based pension system works best when earnings are predictable, employment is formal, and workers can save regularly over decades. In India, that assumption holds for only a minority of the workforce.

Existing public safety nets acknowledge this vulnerability but do not provide meaningful income security. The Atal Pension Yojana assumes sustained contributions across one's working life, which is difficult for informal workers with volatile incomes. The old-age pension under the National Social Assistance Programme remains ₹200 a month for those aged 60 to 79 and ₹500 for those above 80. Such support does not protect the elderly from dependence.

Income security, however, is only one part of the problem. For generations, India's welfare state has been partly hidden inside the household. The joint family, co-resident children, and unpaid female care absorbed many of the costs of old age. That arrangement is weakening under the pressure of urbanisation, migration, nuclear households, and women's educational and work aspirations. Studies of left-behind elderly parents show that while children's migration improves monetary resources, it worsens loneliness and health vulnerability.

To be sure, India has about 150 million people aged 60 and above. By 2050, that number is projected to rise to 347 million, or nearly one-fifth of the population. Yet the income base of old age remains weak. NITI Aayog has noted that 70% of the elderly depend on

others while 78% have no pension cover. These numbers explain why India needs an inflation-indexed minimum pension floor, not as a substitute for contributory pensions, but as a basic layer of public risk-pooling for old age.

Ageing will also change the nature of healthcare demand. The pressure will come from the long-term management of hypertension, diabetes, dementia, disability, and palliative dependence. India has shown that sustained public investment can alter demographic outcomes. It did so for fertility, institutional deliveries, and child survival. The same mission-mode action will now be needed for embedding geriatric care into nursing practice, district health planning, and primary care.

The question of migration

The transition also has a federal dimension. The fastest-ageing States will increasingly need workers from younger States. This could be a source of national balance, but only if younger States invest aggressively in education, health, and skills, so that their workers do not merely move into low-wage informality elsewhere. It will also require older, richer, and more urbanised States to treat migrants not as temporary labour but as citizens who help sustain their economies and therefore deserve portable protection. A national labour market cannot rest on welfare systems tied narrowly to domicile. If workers move across State borders, their entitlements must move with them. Portability of welfare benefits must be one of the foundations of an ageing economy.

International evidence shows that low fertility can accompany prosperity. The difficulty is that India is entering mass ageing before completing the transitions that made ageing manageable elsewhere. India's low-fertility future will be sustainable only if stronger public systems gradually assume responsibilities that large families once carried quietly.

Furore over the Mekedatu project

Tamil Nadu may be waging a losing battle in its fight to get the project scrapped

STATE OF PLAY

T. Ramakrishnan

The row over the Mekedatu dam project, which has been a thorn in the relationship between Tamil Nadu and Karnataka, has resurfaced with the Tamil Nadu Assembly adopting a unanimous resolution against the Karnataka government's proposal for constructing a drinking water-cum-balancing reservoir across the Cauvery river at Mekedatu.

The reason for the resolution was apparently the preparation on the part of the upper riparian State to go ahead with the submission of a revised Detailed Project Report (DPR) on the Mekedatu proposal in light of the Supreme Court dismissing Tamil Nadu's petition to review a November 2025 decision; the court termed the State's challenge to Karnataka's proposed dam as "premature". The project envisages impounding 67.16 thousand million cubic ft (TMC ft) through a ₹9,000-crore drinking water-cum-balancing reservoir at Mekedatu, about 100 km from Bengaluru. It would have a 400 MW (megawatt) hydro power component but no irrigation component.

In the Supreme Court's 2018 judgment on the Cauvery dispute, Karnataka had been sanctioned an additional 4.75 TMC for Bengaluru's drinking water requirements.

On the face of it, the Mekedatu project, which is being proposed to cater to Bengaluru's requirements, should not even be a matter of concern to the lower riparian State. But what is complicating the issue is the trust deficit between the two riparian States, as a result of which Tamil Nadu views the



proposal with suspicion for legitimate reasons. The lower riparian State's basic point is that the Cauvery being deficit, no new project is permissible.

Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar and his colleagues have said that the new dam will benefit Tamil Nadu too as it will serve as a balancing reservoir to regulate the flood flows from the upstream Krishnaraja Sagar and Kabini to the Mettur dam downstream in the lower riparian State.

A tense negotiation

In the last 10-odd years, the Tamil Nadu Assembly has passed, on several occasions, motions against the project.

However, a new element to the contentious matter is the lower riparian State's demand for a tribunal to examine the pros and cons of the project. Though the Tamil Nadu government sent a formal communication on March 4 to the Centre, this was kept under wraps till June 19, the day on which the House adopted the resolution.

The previous Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam government, which took the decision to seek a tribunal for the project, had, for inexplicable reasons, maintained silence and the present Tamilaga Vettri Kaha-gam government too followed suit till now.

However, the Leader of Opposition and former Deputy

Chief Minister Udhayanidhi Stalin disclosed it last week in the House and requested Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay to include it in the resolution. Mr Vijay immediately agreed to the request but former Chief Minister and the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami pointed out that there was a procedural lapse with regard to the way the amendment was incorporated in the resolution.

When Tamil Nadu had pursued the concept of a tribunal in the past to resolve the basic dispute over the sharing of Cauvery river water, it had done so after attending 23 bilateral or tripartite or multi-stakeholder meetings involving the governments of Karnataka, Kerala, and the Union Territory of Puducherry, besides the Central government. However, in the last 15 years, not even one meeting took place between the two principal States on the Mekedatu issue. Under such circumstances, it is not known whether the Union government will take a sympathetic view of Tamil Nadu's request, as the Inter-State River Water Disputes Act requires the Centre to accept the demand for a tribunal only when it is convinced that the dispute cannot be settled through negotiations.

Even if the idea is acceded to, there is no guarantee that Tamil Nadu will be able to succeed in its plan of scrapping the project.

To safeguard the interests of farmers and ensure that the drinking water requirements of Bengaluru be met, the two States can explore the possibility of building a dam in Rasimanal, which is in Tamil Nadu, for a similar capacity.

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Afghan women are increasingly turning to entrepreneurship

Female labour-force participation has fallen to around 5% while women's university enrolment has dropped from nearly 55,000 students in 2019 to zero

DATA POINT

Devvyanshi Bihani

The Taliban's draconian restrictions over the past five years have led to Afghan women facing an unprecedented rollback of rights and freedoms. As universities and many formal workplaces become inaccessible, a growing number of women are turning to small-scale entrepreneurship as one of the few remaining avenues to earn a livelihood. According to World Bank and ILO estimates, female labour-force participation declined from 14.6% in 2021 to 5.2% in 2022 and stood at approximately 5.1% in 2024 and 2025. Male participation remained close to 70% (Chart 1).

Data from Afghanistan's National Statistics and Information Authority shows the scale of the exclusion. In 2019, Afghan universities enrolled 54,861 female students. By 2023-24, that number had fallen to just 102, and by 2024-25 no female students were recorded in any universities. Female admissions followed a similar trajectory, dropping from 16,496 new entrants in 2019 to zero in both 2023-24 and 2024-25. Female graduates also disappeared from the system, falling from 9,937 in 2019 to 67 in 2023-24 and none in 2024-25 (Chart 2). Male enrolment also declined over the same period. UNICEF and UNESCO have attributed the deterioration in educational outcomes to a combination of restrictive policies, chronic underinvestment, recurring humanitarian crisis, widespread learning poverty, and teacher shortages.

These figures reflect the impact of Taliban policies that have barred women and girls from secondary and higher education. Additionally, more than 80% of female media workers lost their jobs when the Taliban returned.

As opportunities in education and formal employment narrowed, many women turned to bu-

sinesses. Data cited by the Afghan Women's Chamber of Commerce and Industry indicates that registered women-owned businesses increased from 2,421 before the restrictions to 9,162 afterward, while estimates of informal women-owned enterprises rose from 52,000 to 1,20,000 (Chart 3). Manufacturing (43%), services (30%) and trade (19%) were the largest sectors, including tailoring, handicrafts, carpet weaving and food processing.

As Afghanistan grapples with economic challenges and international isolation, Taliban officials have framed support for women-led businesses as part of a broader push for economic self-sufficiency. In a Reuters interview, acting commerce minister Haji Nooruddin Azizi said, "We always support women investors" and "We will support any item which can help us for self-sufficiency."

While the number of women-owned enterprises has grown, a 2024 UNDP survey of 3,122 women-led SMEs across 18 provinces highlights the challenges facing women entrepreneurs. Only 28% were formally registered and licensed, while nearly two-thirds operated without registration (Chart 4).

The lack of formal registration limits access to markets, finance and opportunities for growth. The strain is evident in the fact that 41% women entrepreneurs reported being in debt. However, only 5% had obtained loans from formal banks; for in order to secure a loan, you need to have a business background, a recommendation letter, and property documents which many Afghan women lack. So they primarily rely on family networks and personal savings to fund their businesses (Table 1).

As universities close their doors to women and their labour force participation remains among the lowest in the world, small businesses have become an economic lifeline for thousands of Afghan women seeking an income.

The last open door

The data for the charts were sourced from World Bank, Afghanistan's National Statistics and Information Authority, Afghan Women Chamber of Commerce and Industries and United Nations Development Programme

CHART 1: Gender-wise labour-force participation in Afghanistan before and after the Taliban's return to power in 2021

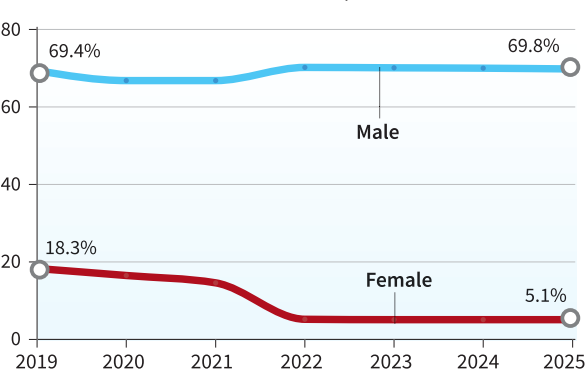


CHART 2: Female participation in Afghanistan's higher education system before and after the Taliban's return to power in 2021

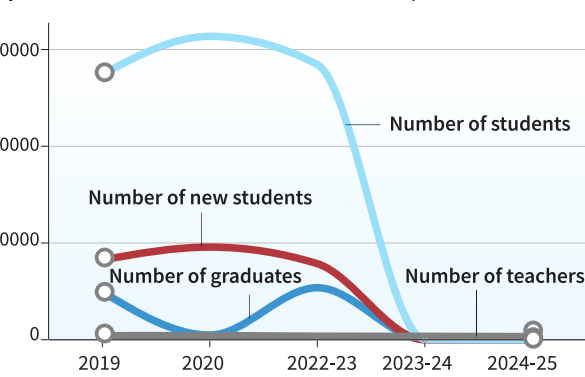


CHART 3: Number of registered and informal women-owned businesses in Afghanistan before and after the Taliban's return to power in 2021

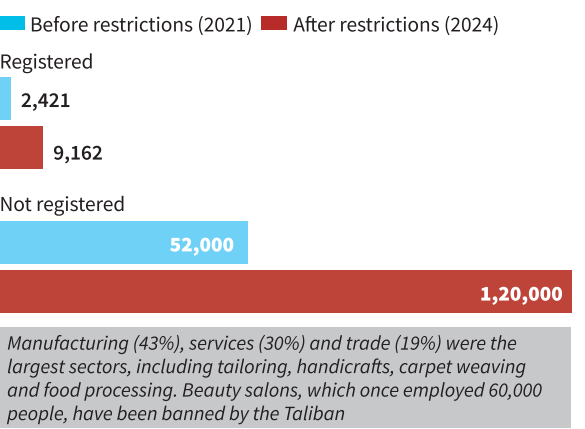


CHART 4: Registration status of women-led enterprises as of 2024, as per a UNDP survey

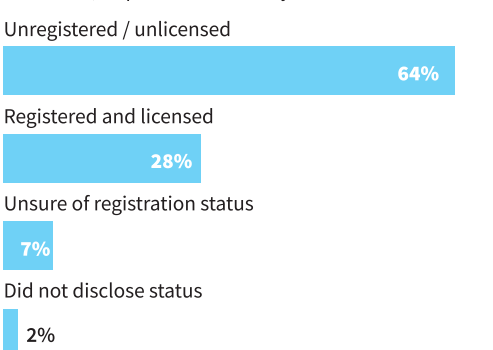


TABLE 1: Sources of financing for women-led small and medium enterprises (SMEs) in Afghanistan as of 2024, as per a UNDP survey

Source of loan / financing	Percentage of women-led SMEs
Family	61%
Friends	45%
Other businesses	21%
Formal banks	5%
Remittances from abroad	5%
Microfinance institutions (MFIs)	2%
Community savings groups	2%
Money service providers/Hawalas	0.30%

Note: Survey respondents could select multiple options. Hence the percentages do not add up to 100%

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO JUNE 25, 1976

Heavy rain likely along west coast

Madras, June 24: The west coast is likely to receive heavy rain in the next two days. According to a special bulletin issued by the weather office here, a well-marked trough of low pressure has formed in the east Arabian Sea over Lakshadweep and off the Kerala, Karnataka, Goa coast.

A low pressure area also lies over the central and adjoining northwest Bay of Bengal off Andhra and Orissa coast.

The southwest monsoon will revive over Kerala and coastal Karnataka in the next 48 hours and widespread rain is expected over Lakshadweep and in Kerala and coastal Karnataka. Isolated heavy rain is likely in the extreme western parts of interior Karnataka during the same period. Squally weather will prevail over Lakshadweep and along and off the Kerala and Karnataka coast during the next two days.

Our Trivandrum correspondent reports: Conditions are now becoming favourable for the strengthening of the southwest monsoon over Kerala according to a special weather bulletin issued by the Meteorological Centre, Trivandrum.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO JUNE 25, 1926

Jubilee of the telephone

Rugby, June 25: The jubilee of the telephone is being celebrated today.

At the institution of Electrical Engineers, Sir Oliver Lodge delivered a lecture, which was broadcast, on the history of the development of the telephone. Newspapers pay tributes to the memory of Professor Alexander Graham Bell, who is regarded as "the father of the telephone." The story is retold how Mr. Bell, a native of Edinburgh, married a girl who had the misfortune to be deaf and how he tried to invent an instrument that would enable her to hear. He chanced to discover the machine that enabled one to hear from a long distance. This he patented in America where he and his wife were living. He brought his invention to England in 1877 and England's first telephone company was registered in June of the following year. The first exchange was opened in August, 1879 at Coleman Street in the City of London with fewer than a dozen subscribers.

CMYK A CH-CHE

Kharge slams Pradhan for ‘terrorist jibe’ on students

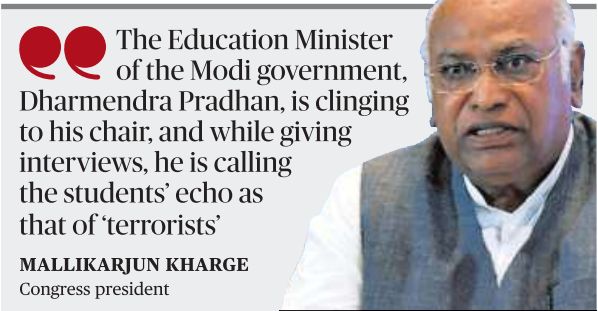
Students’ movement will continue to gain strength, he says and calls for Minister’s resignation; party to hold press conferences in 28 cities demanding an overhaul of Indian education system

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge on Wednesday hit out at Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan for his reported “terrorist” remark against protesting students, and asserted that the Minister would have to resign.

The Congress president’s reference was to a comment by Mr. Pradhan, made during a television interview, in which he referred Opposition leader Rahul Gandhi’s interactions with students at Rajasthan’s education hub Kota on June 17. He said Mr. Gandhi was trying to “spread terrorism” and referred to the Cockroach Janta Party as “the B team of terrorists”. Mr. Pradhan’s remarks amounted to calling the protesting students “terrorists”, the Congress alleged.

In a post on social media platform X, Mr. Kharge linked the remark to concerns over examination



paper leaks and their impact on students. “Ninety paper leaks have occurred, the futures of millions of students have been ruined, 20 children have taken their own lives due to the NEET paper leak, families have been devastated...,” he said.

‘Refused responsibility’
The Congress president alleged that despite the controversies surrounding examination irregularities, Mr. Pradhan had refused to take responsibility. “The Education Minister of the Modi government, Dharmendra Pradhan, is clinging to his chair, and while giving interviews, he is calling the ‘students’ echo’ as

that of ‘terrorists,’” Mr. Kharge said.

He drew a parallel with the Centre’s response to earlier protests. “The country has not forgotten that Prime Minister Modi himself, in Parliament, had insultingly labelled the farmer benefactors ‘*andolan-jeevi*’ (living off agitations) and ‘*parjeevi*’ (parasites). Whoever questions this government is called an anti-national,” Mr. Kharge said.

Mr. Kharge said the students’ movement would continue to gain strength and called for Mr. Pradhan’s resignation.

“*Chhatron Ki Goonj* (Congress’s ‘echo of students’ campaign) will echo

loudly across the entire country; Modi’s Minister Pradhan will have to resign,” he said.

The party also announced that it would hold press conferences across 28 cities on Thursday under the banner of “*Chhatron Ki Goonj*”.

“Through this campaign, the Indian National Congress demands a comprehensive overhaul of India’s education system, beginning with the resignation of Union Education Minister Shri Dharmendra Pradhan, who epitomises the Modi government’s lack of vision and dogmatic approach to education,” Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal said.

“Over the past 12 years, the RSS-BJP government has only pursued the privatisation, centralisation, and ‘sanghification’ of education, and done too little to prepare India’s youth for the future. The crisis today is not only one of unemployment but also of employability,” he said.

Donation theft in Ayodhya, land grab in Mahakal show new Modi model: Congress

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Wednesday linked the alleged embezzlement of donations at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya with the land acquisition controversy involving Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav in Ujjain, close to the Mahakal Temple.

The party accused the BJP of playing with people’s faith for financial and political gain.

Addressing a joint press conference with Madhya Pradesh Congress chief Jitu Patwari, Congress media and publicity wing head Pawan Khara said these developments pointed not only to corruption but also to a betrayal of people’s faith.

“Ujjain and Ayodhya are international issues. People’s faith is linked to these cities. People are frugal to be able to save and go on pilgrimages. Looting the money, carrying out a theft, is like stabbing people’s faith,” Mr. Khara said, referring to allegations that huge amounts of donations



Seeking action: Youth Congress workers staging a protest over an alleged Ujjain land scam, in Bhopal on Wednesday. PTI

have been siphoned off by people in the Trust that manages the Ram Mandir in Ayodhya.

“Donation theft in Ayodhya and land grab in Mahakal, this is the new Modi model,” Mr. Patwari said, questioning the “silence” of Prime Minister Narendra Modi on both issues.

Land grab row
The remarks come amid a controversy triggered by reports that Mr. Yadav’s family members and real estate firms linked to them acquired large tracts of land in and around Ujjain after he assumed office in December 2023.

An investigation pu-

blished this week reported that the family and associated entities purchased at least 137 plots covering about 168 acres, much of it in areas expected to benefit from proposed road projects and land-use changes linked to Ujjain’s expansion ahead of the 2028 Simhashta Maha Kumbh.

Mr. Khara said former Congress leader Ashok Chavan, who is now in the BJP, had to resign as Maharashtra Chief Minister over charges that his mother-in-law owned an apartment in the Adarsh Housing Society in Mumbai. “In this matter, no action is expected from Mr. Modi,” he said.

AAP under fire over CM ‘sacrilege video’ row

Vikas Vasudeva
CHANDIGARH

The controversy over a video allegedly linked to actions by Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann amounting to sacrilege under a new law and a stand-off with the Akal Takht, the highest Sikh temporal seat, has put the Aam Aadmi Party under pressure.

On Wednesday, a day after the Haryana Police arrested two men for allegedly conspiring to prepare forged forensic and cyberanalysis reports in connection with the purported video of Mr. Mann, Opposition parties launched an all-out attack ahead of the State Assembly election in early 2027.

Shiromani Akali Dal leaders demanded the matter be handed over to the Central Bureau of Investigation for a probe. Punjab Congress leaders demanded Mr. Mann’s immediate resignation and the registration of an FIR against him under the new sacrilege law.

Mr. Maan said a fake video had been deliberately created and circulated to defame him.

On the draw



BJP imposing vegetarianism in Bengal, says Trinamool

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

The West Bengal government’s decision to engage the International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON) for providing cooked meals in schools across the Kolkata Municipal Corporation area, has drawn fire from Opposition parties.

They claim that the move was an attempt to impose vegetarianism by the BJP government.

Trinamool Congress MP Derek O’ Brien criticised the move and said it was an attempt to deprive children of nutrition by denying them eggs.

“After the fish eating *ta-masha* during the election campaign, the Gujarat Gymkhana finally reveals itself. Throw eggs at rivals. But deprive children of nutrition by taking eggs off from midday meals. Imposing vegetarianism. Bengal rejects this,” he said.

ISKCON spokesperson Radharaman Das said the meals would not contain eggs but would instead include ingredients such as paneer, kidney beans, and other vegetarian protein sources. Eggs have always been part of the menu for children in the State.

House panel seeks Ministry report on Great Nicobar Project

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Chairperson of the Public Accounts Committee, K.C. Venugopal, has sought a report from the Union Home Ministry on the Great Nicobar Project.

The Congress has accused the government of imperilling the fragile Nicobar islands ecosystem for commercial purposes.

The PAC was meeting to deliberate the report of the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) report on the “establishment and functioning of Andaman and Nicobar Islands Institute of Medical Sciences”.

During his concluding remarks, Mr. Venugopal flagged the Great Nicobar Project, pointing to the rising panic among the residents there as 1.5 crore trees are slated to be felled to make way for the project. He further pointed out, sources said, that the naval base *INS Baaz* was not given additional land for its expansion; and the government was exploiting this fragile ecology for commercial activities. Congress MP Amar Singh also backed Mr. Venugopal, detailing the implications of the project, which the government, he said, was not



accounting for. Sources said BJP MP Anurag Singh Thakur interceded to point out that this issue was beyond the agenda of the meeting.

Mr. Venugopal agreed, though he directed Home Secretary Govind Mohan to submit a comprehensive report detailing all aspects of the project.

On the listed subject of the day, the Andaman and Nicobar Islands Institute of Medical Sciences, the panel pointed out there was a massive funding deficit and indefinite delay in completing the civil construction.

The CAG report has also flagged deficiencies in equipment and patient care. The Home Ministry shifted the blame for these deficiencies to the Union Health Ministry.

Shiv Sena (UBT) MPs seek copy of rebels’ letter

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI

Two Shiv Sena (UBT) MPs on Wednesday met Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla and sought a copy of the letter submitted by the party’s six rebel MPs who recently announced that had joined the Shiv Sena led by Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde.

The MPs, Anil Desai and Arvind Sawant, also sought to know the demands made by the rebel MPs.

“We had earlier given the Speaker a letter of caveat. He had accordingly called us. We asked him if the rebel MPs had given him any letter. We asked him if they came as a group or as individuals. We told him that you need to in-

form us. We gave a copy of the Constitution, highlighting the provisions of the Tenth Schedule. A political party can merge if it wants to. But the party has to decide. There was no party meeting. No such proposal was moved by either of the six of them,” Mr. Sawant told *The Hindu* after the meeting.

The Shiv Sena (UBT) has

questioned the lack of transparency surrounding the entry of the six MPs into the ruling Shiv Sena. It had submitted a letter to the Speaker seeking a hearing in case any group of leaders of their party approaches him to form a separate group. “If anybody goes to meet the Speaker, the information is put out by his office. The pho-

tos are shared on his social media handle. There is openness and transparency in the matter. But when it has come to this merger, there is no information about it,” a Shiv Sena (UBT) leader said.

Leaders of the Shiv Sena said all the legislative processes had been completed to induct the six MPs into the party.

Anna Hazare warns of stir against RTI amendments

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI

Civil rights activist Anna Hazare on Wednesday issued an ultimatum to the Maharashtra government calling for the withdrawal of the Maharashtra Right to Information (Amendment) Rules, 2026.

He said a meeting with the Maharashtra Chief Information Commissioner in Ralegan Siddhi was “unsatisfactory”. “If they don’t withdraw the amendments and if people’s interest is jeopardised, I will hit the streets once again,” he told presspersons.

Calling for a struggle against the amendments, he expressed dissatisfaction with the State government’s policies.

“If the soul of the RTI Act has to be kept alive, a new committee needs to be formed immediately,” he said.

इण्डियन ओवरसीज़ बैंक
Indian Overseas Bank
Information Technology Department
Central Office: 763, Anna Salai, Chennai-600002

Indian Overseas bank (IOB) invites bids for the following:

GOVERNMENT E-MARKET PORTAL - SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND OPERATIONALISATION OF VIDEO CONFERENCE INFRASTRUCTURE AND ENDPOINTS
BID NO: GEM/2026/BI/7697273 DATED 22.06.2026

The Above GEM Tender document is also available and can be downloaded from the following websites www.iob.bank.in & www.gem.gov.in For Tender details and future amendments, if any, keep referring to the following website www.gem.gov.in

ANDHRA PRADESH POWER GENERATION CORPORATION LTD.
VIDYUT SOUDHA, GUNADALA, VIJAYAWADA-520 004.

Notification for the post of Assistant Executive Engineer (Electrical/ Mechanical/ Electronics), Assistant Executive Engineer (Civil)

APGENCO invites applications to fill the posts of Assistant Executive Engineer (Electrical/ Mechanical/ Electronics) - 80 Nos, Assistant Executive Engineer (Civil)- 20 Nos. The detailed Notification regarding Educational Qualification, Age, Date of uploading of applications through online and last date of submission of application etc., will be available on APGENCO website <https://apgenco.gov.in> and <https://apvidyutrecruitment.apcfss.in>.

P. PULLA REDDY
MANAGING DIRECTOR (FAC)

DELHI TRANSCO LIMITED

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER

Delhi Transco Ltd, a Government of NCT of Delhi Undertaking, invites online tender for the work:

Tender No.T25R220484: Design, Engineering, Supply, Erection, Testing and Commissioning of 400/220/66kV GIS Tikrikhurd Sub-Station with complete civil works & automation on Turnkey Basis.

For complete details of the tender please visit following websites :-
<https://govtprocurement.delhi.gov.in> (Tender ID No. 2026_DTL_294145_1) and www.dtl.gov.in with Unique No. DTL-0060-240626

Last date for bid submission: **18.08.2026 at 01.30 P.M.**

All Corrigendum/Addendum/ Amendments/ Date of Extension/ Clarifications etc. to this e-tender will be hosted on the above website only. Bidders should regularly visit website to keep themselves updated.

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, DHENKANAL (R&B) DIVISION, DHENKANAL
Letter no. 4171, Dt.23.06.26
Email ID - eedklpww@gmail.com

Cancellation of Bid Identification-SE-DKL-No.08 of 2026-27

The tender received for the following 6(Six) Nos Electrical works in response to E-Procurement Notice No-08/2026-27 with Bid Identification No- SEDKL-No.08 of 2026-27 is hereby cancelled due to administrative reason and fresh tender will be invited.

1. Installation of Aerosol Based Extinguisher and Lightning Protection at 4th floor, 5th floor and 6th floor and Lightning Protection at DHH Dhenkanal (Tender ID : 2026_EICCL_129697_1).
2. Installation of Aerosol Based Extinguisher at Blood Bank, Ticket Counter, Patient Attendance Rest Shed and Diarrhea Ward and Lightning Protection of DHH Dhenkanal (Tender ID: 2026_EICCL_129697_5).
3. Installation of Aerosol Based Extinguisher and Lightning Protection at CHC, Bellikiri of Dhenkanal (Tender ID : 2026_EICCL_129697_3).
4. Installation of Aerosol Based Extinguisher and lightning protection at CHC Parjang (Tender ID : 2026_EICCL_129697_2).
5. Installation of Aerosol Based Extinguisher and Lightning Protection at SDH Hindol of Dhenkanal for the year (Tender ID 2026_EICCL_129697_4).
6. Installation of Aerosol Based Extinguisher Transformer & DG, LT Panel, Fire Panel, Main Panel and Feeder Panel of DHH Dhenkanal (Tender ID : 2026_EICCL_129697_6).

Superintending Engineer, Dhenkanal (R&B) Division, Dhenkanal.
34001/387/2627 OIPR-34001/34016/126-27/0014

DIRECTORATE OF AYUSH
(Ayurveda, Yoga & Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha & Homoeopathy)
Department of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of Odisha
Heads of Department Building, 3rd Floor, (Annex), Unit-5, Bhubaneswar-751001
Tel: 0674-2394577, FAX:06742391180, Email: directorayushodisha@gmail.com,
Web:<https://ayush.odisha.gov.in>

EOI Ref. 7118 /DAYUSH, Dated. 24.06.2026

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

Expression of Interest (EOI) are invited from eligible AYUSH Approved Drugs Testing Laboratories under Rule 160- A to J of the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules 1945 read with the Ministry of AYUSH Letter No. J-14020/2/2022-DCC, Dtd. 21.07.2022 for test/ analysis of AYUSH drugs (Ayurvedic & Homoeopathic) procured by the Directorate of AYUSH, Odisha.

The EOI document with all information relating to the bidding process including cost of bid document, EMDs, pre-qualification criteria and terms & conditions etc. are available in the website of Directorate of AYUSH, Odisha i.e. <https://ayush.odisha.gov.in> . The prospective bidders are requested to visit the website of Directorate of AYUSH for downloading the aforesaid EOI documents as well as for any published notice/ corrigendum etc. against the EOI from time to time. The EOI Authority reserves the right to accept/ reject/sought clarification any part thereof or all the bids without assigning any reason thereof.

Director, AYUSH, Odisha
10001/305/2627 OIPR-10001/100561/126-27/0007

ANDHRA PRADESH CENTRAL POWER DISTRIBUTION CORPORATION LTD
Corporate Office, Vidut Niyagam, Beside Vidut Soudha, Gunadala, Vijayawada - 520004.

APCPDCL invites applications from the eligible candidates for filling up of posts of Assistant Executive Engineer(Electrical)-56 nos., Assistant Executive Engineer(Civil)-3 nos, Assistant Executive Engineer(Telecom)-1 no. For detailed Notification along with breakup of vacancies etc., visit APCPDCL website: <https://www.apcpdcl.in> and <https://apvidyutrecruitment.apcfss.in>

Place: Vijayawada, Date : 24.06.2026 Sd/- Chairman and Managing Director

EASTERN POWER DISTRIBUTION COMPANY OF A.P. LTD
Corporate Office, P&T Colony, Seethammadhara, Visakhapatnam-530 013.

RECRUITMENT NOTIFICATION

APEPDCL invites applications from the eligible candidates for filling up of posts of Assistant Executive Engineer (Electrical)-128, Assistant Executive Engineer (Civil)-4, and Assistant Executive Engineer (Telecom)-3. For detailed notification along with break-up of vacancies etc., visit APEPDCL website <https://apeasternpower.com> & <https://apvidyutrecruitment.apcfss.in>

Sd/-
Place: Visakhapatnam, Date: 25-06-2026, Advt-28 Chairman & Managing Director

SOUTHERN POWER DISTRIBUTION COMPANY OF A.P. LIMITED
Corporate office: H.No.19-13-35/A, Srinivasapuram, Tiruchanoor Road, Tirupati-517503

NOTIFICATION FOR THE POST OF ASSISTANT EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (ELECTRICAL), ASSISTANT EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (CIVIL) & ASSISTANT EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (TELECOM)

APSPDCL invites applications to fill the posts of Assistant Executive Engineers (Electrical) -125 Nos. (including 1 No. Backlog), Assistant Executive Engineers (Civil) -6 Nos. and Assistant Executive Engineers (Telecom)-4 Nos. The detailed notification regarding educational qualification, age, date of uploading of applications through online and last date of submission of applications etc., will be available on APSPDCL website <http://apspdcl.in> and <http://apvidyutrecruitment.apcfss.in>

Place: Tirupati, Date: 25.06.2026 CHAIRMAN & MANAGING DIRECTOR

Kalyan Singh Super Speciality Cancer Institute
C.G. City, Sultanpur Road, Lucknow-(226002)
Website: <https://cancerinstitute.edu.in>, Email: jdmm.sscslh@gmail.com

CORRIGENDUM

Reference to GeM Bid No. GEM/2026/BI/7592452 dated 02.06.2026

Corrigendum regarding amendments in eligibility criteria, technical and operational conditions, scope of work, commencement provisions, PET-CT service requirements, applicable charges and other terms & conditions of the PET-CT Services Bid. Detailed corrigendum may be reviewed on the Institute website and GeM Portal.

Advt No: KSSSCI/EOI-03/2026-27 DIRECTOR

INBRIEF



Farmer group protests against India-U.S. trade deal in Punjab

Farmers and farm labourers under the banner of the Kisan Mazdoor Morcha on Wednesday staged demonstrations in Punjab against the proposed India-U.S. trade deal, alleging that the agreement could adversely impact not just farmers, but labourers, shopkeepers, and the youth. Protests were held at several places across 21 districts of Punjab. “The objective of the protest was to democratically register opposition and bring the truth about the dangerous consequences of this agreement to the people of the country,” Sarwan Singh Pandher, senior KMM leader, said.

India and UAE explore ways to strengthen defence ties

India and the UAE reviewed progress made under their Strategic Defence Partnership Framework on Wednesday. The meeting, held in New Delhi, was co-chaired by Joint Secretary (International Cooperation) Amitabh Prasad and UAE Staff Brigadier Jamal Ebrahim Mohamed Ebrahim Almar-Zooqi. Both sides explored ways to deepen collaboration in defence manufacturing, foster innovation, and strengthen security cooperation in the maritime domain. According to sources, India is in talks with the UAE to export some of its flagship military platforms, including the BrahMos supersonic cruise missile.

Fiancée, lover held in Ketan Agarwal murder case

Chinmay Gaikwad
PUNE

The Pune Rural Police have arrested Ketan Agarwal's fiancée Siya Goyal and her lover Chetan Chaudhary in connection with his murder at Lohagad Fort. However, investigators remain uncertain about which of the two accused physically pushed Ketan from the cliff.

The death of Ketan Agarwal at Lohagad Fort on June 18, initially registered as an accidental fall, has been reclassified as a pre-planned murder following a police investigation. The investigation has revealed that the accused had conducted reconnaissance of the location twice before the incident.

The police investigation has established that Siya and Chetan allegedly acted in concert to kill Ketan. However, investigators have not determined whether Siya, who was walking alongside Ketan at the time of the incident, allegedly pushed him, or whether Chetan, who was waiting at the location, allegedly delivered the fatal push.

The police are examining forensic evidence and witness statements to ascertain this detail.

Heavy rain triggers landslides, flash flood in Arunachal Pradesh

One person killed, four reported missing as six districts remain cut off; Assam issues a high alert in districts downstream of the affected areas

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

One person was killed and four were reported missing after heavy rain triggered flash floods and landslides in Arunachal Pradesh, officials in Keyi Panyor district said on Wednesday. Six districts remained cut off as road connectivity was disrupted in several areas.

The flash floods followed heavy rain on Tuesday night, affecting areas in and around the public sector North Eastern Electric Power Corporation Ltd. (NEEPCO) project site in Yazali Circle in the district. Nearly 50 houses were damaged.

Angad Mehta, Superintendent of Police, Keyi Panyor, said the body of 35-year-old Nirmala Gupta, a teacher at the NEEPCO's Vivekananda Kendriya Vidyalaya, was recovered after hours of search. “The rescue operation with inflatable craft will continue on Thursday,” he told *The*



Debris scattered across an area after flash floods near the NEEPCO project colony in Arunachal Pradesh on Wednesday. PTI

Hindu, adding that the Indian Air Force carried out sorties to assess the damage and locate survivors.

Earlier, a statement issued by the district police said the “monsoon-related disruptions” had cut off large parts of the district and five others – Kamle, Kra Daadi, Kurung Kumey, Lower Subansiri, and Upper Subansiri.

While major landslides have been reported from several stretches on key highways, a strategic bridge connecting two oth-

er districts, East Kameng and Pakke Kessang, was damaged. “Personnel of the Border Roads Organisation and the Highway Department have been engaged to expedite restoration work,” Mr. Mehta said.

Assam on alert

The Assam government has issued a high alert in the districts downstream of the areas hit by “extremely heavy rainfall and flash floods” in Arunachal Pradesh.

NMC will phase out PG diploma medical courses from 2027-28

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI

The National Medical Commission (NMC) has announced the final phasing out of postgraduate diploma courses, stating that 2026-27 will be the last academic year for admission to these programmes. It has now directed all medical colleges, institutions, and universities to accordingly comply with the procedures.

The latest order issued this week says that from 2027-28, specialist training in medical colleges will be offered only through MD and MS degree programmes, and institutions are supposed to convert existing diploma seats into degree seats.

Standardisation bid

Medical colleges have been asked to apply for conversion through the Medical Assessment and Rating Board (MARB). The move, according to the NMC, is intended to standardise postgraduate medical education, improve the quality and recognition of specialist training, align qualifications with current educational standards, and make better use of existing in-

The move, according to the NMC, is intended to standardise PG medical education

frastructure in medical colleges.

Traditional diplomas, including diploma in otorhinolaryngology (ENT), ophthalmology, dermatology, venereology and leprosy, tuberculosis and chest diseases, and public health and medical radiotherapy are typically two years long, compared with the three-year MD or MS degree programmes, and played an important role in producing specialists for district hospitals and smaller towns.

“We will have to assess the impact of the move on rural and district-level specialist availability. Traditional diplomas provided a quicker route to specialist training and supplied many doctors to smaller hospitals. The policy question now is whether converting all seats to MD/MS will improve quality without reducing the number of specialists available outside major cities,” said a health expert.

Man killed on Mumbai local train following altercation

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

A 22-year-old man was allegedly stabbed to death by a co-passenger on a Mumbai local train during an argument over whether the doors should be kept open amid the rain, officials said on Wednesday.

The incident took place inside a first-class compartment on Tuesday. The accused, identified as Roshan Suvarna, was arrested hours after the incident.

The police said Suvarna stabbed Mayank Lohar following an altercation. One of them wanted the doors to be kept open, while the other objected, citing the rain. Lohar suffered injuries and collapsed, while Suvarna jumped off the train at Borivali station before it came to a halt and ran away. The Government Railway Police have registered a case of murder.

SC had agreed that right to associate is no *carte blanche* for foreign funds

NEWS ANALYSIS

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Rules, 2026, notified by the Union Home Ministry on June 22, has introduced tougher limits on NGOs to receive foreign donations.

These amendments, and the ones before them, source their legality from the Centre's argument in the Supreme Court that the freedom to form associations or engage in the “business” of charity does not include a right to receive unbridled foreign funds or to use the money outside “permissible activities”.

Among other changes, Rule 9(1B) mandates that certificates of registration of NGOs must specify the “purpose or purposes and the States or Union Territories”.

The Rules have introduced tougher limits on NGOs to receive foreign donations

The Rules limit NGOs to specific and stated spheres of activity, which exclude proselytisation, and geographical bounds.

SC judgments

The government's sweeping powers to regulate foreign donations have been blessed by the Supreme Court in multiple judgments. A three-judge Bench in *Noel Harper versus Union of India* in April 2022 declared that “no one can be heard to claim a vested right to accept foreign donation, much less an absolute right”.

The court had disapproved of the tendency to seek funds abroad, saying it gave an impression that

the nation was incapable of looking after its own needs.

A March 2020 decision of the Supreme Court in *Indian Social Action Forum (INSAF) versus Union of India* had agreed with the Centre that the “regulation of acceptance and utilisation of foreign contribution is for the purpose of protecting national interest”. The court had, however, in this case, called for a “balance” between the law's objective and the rights of the voluntary organisations to access foreign funds. The *INSAF* judgment declared that only associations which play a role in active or party politics were barred from accessing foreign funds.

The government has argued in court that the FCRA, its Rules, and amendments were meant to regulate the manner of doing business, more importantly, concerning fo-

reign contributions. The FCRA did not intend to stop charitable work. It has argued that the regulatory regime did not hurt the fundamental rights of individuals to form associations or practice a profession or carry on an occupation, trade or business under Article 19(1)(c) and Article 19(1)(g), respectively, of the Constitution.

The Centre has referred to Article 19(4) to demonstrate that it could frame laws to reasonably restrict the fundamental freedom to form associations under Article 19(1)(c) in the interest of the sovereignty and integrity of India or to protect public order or morality. Similarly, Article 19(6) allowed the government to impose reasonable fetters on the right to trade, business, occupation available under Article 19(1)(g) if the State could show these freedoms were against public interest.

Top court backs lower cut-off in NEET-super speciality for admission of govt. doctors

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Wednesday said the cut-off or qualifying percentile for the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test-super speciality (NEET-SS) seats for in-service government doctors in States must be reduced for they serve the public and study at the same time.

A Bench of Justices B.V. Nagarathna and Joymalya Bagchi said the access for in-service government doctors to speciality medical courses must become easier as their healing skills would not be used for personal profit but for the benefit of the larger public.

The court made the oral observations while hearing a petition filed by the Tamil Nadu Medical Officers' Association, represented by senior advocate P. Wilson.



The petition challenged the “premature diversion” of 152 vacant super-speciality seats earmarked for in-service government doctors in Tamil Nadu to the all-India quota. It sought protection of the State's in-service reservation policy, pending a final decision on the reduction of the NEET-SS qualifying percentile.

“If you just take away super-speciality seats and transfer to the all-India quota, how will the State doctors benefit? They work for the people of the State. They work in State government hospitals. The seats

were earmarked for them to enable them to achieve greater skills to heal the public,” Justice Nagarathna said.

In-service government doctors must get a lower cut-off, the judge said. “Unlike someone who can sit at home and study, the government doctors are working and studying. They are an essential part of the public health infrastructure... The qualifying percentile has to be reduced for them. If you take seats away from the very people serving public health, how would that help the States?” she said.

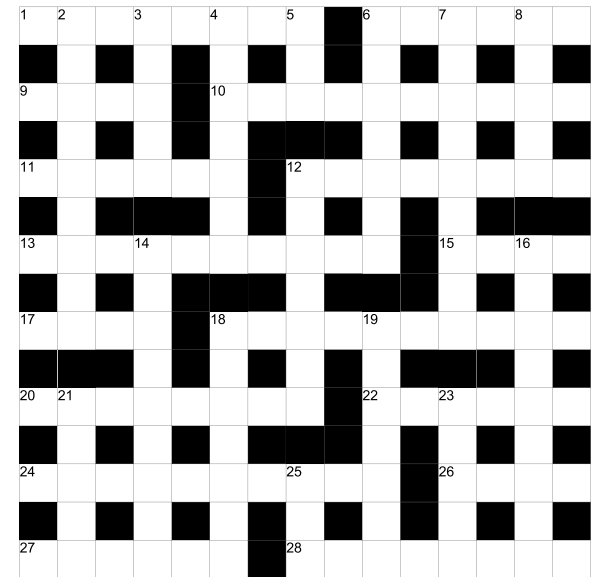
The court issued notice to the Union government, the Director-General of Health Services, the National Medical Council, the State of Tamil Nadu, the Medical Counselling Committee, and other respondents.

THE HINDU CROSSWORD+ 14829

(set by Gussalufz)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at <https://thehindu.com/crosswords>

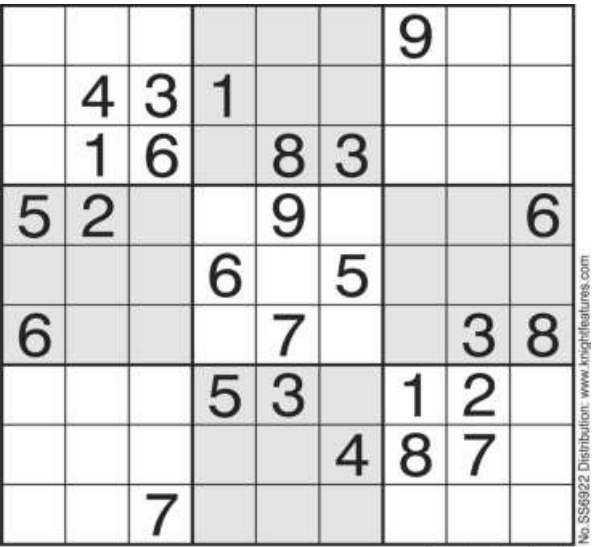
SCAN TO PLAY



13. Om: "I bit mice, dubiously imitating nature" (10)
15. Gussalufz accompanying gangster for lunch? (4)
17. Unchanged support after leader's ouster (2,2)
18. Son, sleep long on ship, for energy (10)
20. Antelope ecosystem buckled after all-round grazing (8)
22. Spicy stew leads to rectal agony (painful inflammation) (6)
24. Young abstainers, taking off clothes, give up and loudly dance on ecstasy (4,2,4)
26. Head priest dined (4)
27. Party offering to preserve copy (6)
28. Grasshoppers returned regularly, used midday attacks (8)
- DOWN
2. Rampant tantrum and rage in resort, for starters (9)
3. A brute, lacking limits in behaviour, goes after small fry (5)
4. Acting in period features (international) (7)
5. Half of trailer cut for interval (3)
6. European with microphone, offering contentious argument (7)
7. Train workers to crawl through hairy mews with caution, ultimately (9)
8. Badaam at first, then take paratha? (5)
12. Ah, turning pitch, where some bowlers might be rested (7)
14. Indian state in upheaval around healthcare staff cut: news outlets (4,5)
16. Like the middle of hamburger slices - seasoned and battered (9)
18. Very upset, not right dish (7)
19. A fine, extremely encyclopedic *Essence of Anatomy* textbook (7)
21. ChatGPT, possibly possessed by craftiness, goes overboard; this might go over one's head (5)
23. Road-racing? A pedestrian crossing sides stared in shock (5)
25. Steep drop terminal for Christmas tree (3)

- ACROSS
1. Workers laid off? Tad fishy (3,5)
6. Ignore outrageous abyss next to eastern edge of camp (4,2)
9. The two of us texted for dinner options? (4)
10. Bali trek is tailor-made for rugged two-wheelers (5,5)
11. Straight storyteller capturing fringes of lesbian lore (6)
12. Detective probing American dude's murder (8)

SUDOKU



Solution to previous puzzle

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

FAITH

Rama punishes Sugreeva

Rama told Sugreeva that He would kill Vaali. Encouraged by Rama's words, Sugreeva fought with Vaali. But Rama did not kill Vaali and Sugreeva was beaten up by his brother Vaali. When Sugreeva asked Rama why He had let him down, Rama replied He was afraid that He might kill the wrong brother by mistake, since both looked alike. This, obviously, was just an excuse. Could the Supreme One not find the difference? Rama wanted Sugreeva to be beaten by Vaali before going to his rescue. There was a reason for this, said Navalpakkam Vasudevachariar in a discourse.

Rama must never tolerate His devotees being slighted. Sugreeva had treated Lakshmana disrespectfully. He would ignore Lakshmana and speak to Rama directly, without involving Lakshmana in the conversation. So, Rama felt that Sugreeva deserved a beating at Vaali's hands. Eventually, He did keep His promise and killed Vaali, but initially He let Sugreeva be defeated by Vaali. Rama told Sugreeva to go and challenge Vaali to a second fight. This time Rama said He would kill him. Sugreeva challenged Vaali to come out and fight again. Vaali's wife Tara warned her husband not to respond to the challenge. She asked him to give up his anger and to act wisely. He had just defeated Sugreeva, but the latter was back wanting to fight again. Something must have changed since the last fight. Tara thought Sugreeva's challenge was suspicious. She felt he had some support. She had heard of two men from Ayodhya who were with Sugreeva. She said he must have taken their help. So, it would be dangerous for Vaali to agree to this fight. But Vaali ignored Tara's warnings and was killed by Rama.

Rubio commits to UAE security during his tour of the Gulf nations



Kim unveils plans for 10,000-tonne warships, nuclear navy in N. Korea



French govt. confirms Ebola virus in doctor who worked in Congo



Pak. court sentences Balochistan rights activist to life imprisonment



Vummidi Bangaru Jewellers (VBJ), recently concluded its first-ever exclusive jewellery exhibition in Mettupalayam, held at Hotel EMS Mayura, 212, Coimbatore Road, Mettupalayam – 641301. The two-day exhibition featured a curated selection of gold, diamond, and solitaire jewellery, including bridal masterpieces, contemporary designs, necklaces, bangles, earrings, rings, lightweight jewellery, and statement creations, reflecting VBJ's legacy of craftsmanship and timeless elegance. Mr. Amarendra Vummidi, Managing Partner, VBJ, said, "We thank everyone who visited and look forward to strengthening our relationship with customers in the region." Mr. Jithendra Vummidi, Managing Partner, VBJ, added, "The appreciation we received inspires us to continue creating meaningful jewellery experiences closer to our patrons."

HARD-FOUGHT CONTEST

Panama out of World Cup after narrow loss to Croatia



REUTERS

Panama was eliminated from the World Cup after Croatia kept its hopes of progressing to the last 32 alive with a 1-0 win in Toronto on Tuesday. Ante Budimir's 54th-minute goal proved enough to see off the spirited Central Americans in the Group L contest that marked Luka Modric's 200th international appearance.

PAYING HOMAGE

DR Congo's living statue fan makes his World Cup debut



REUTERS

DR Congo's famous living statue finally made his World Cup debut on Tuesday. Michel Nkuka Mboladinga, who gained fame during the AFCON for posing as a statue of Congo's assassinated independence leader Patrice Lumumba for the entirety of games, attended the match against Colombia after missing the opener against Portugal.

BARREN

England sets dubious distinction for the most goalless draws



REUTERS

England set an unwanted record for the most goalless draws in FIFA World Cup history after its 0-0 stalemate against Carlos Queiroz's Ghana in the Group L clash in Massachusetts on Tuesday. England's total number of goalless matches in FIFA World Cup history has risen to 13.

BEST IN THE BUSINESS

Record for most goals scored in the group stage broken



GETTY IMAGES

The first 48 matches of the 2026 World Cup have produced 141 goals, the highest tally in the group phase of a single edition of the global tournament. The previous record stood at 136 goals, which was set during the 2014 World Cup that had 48 group-stage games. The latest mark was created in Portugal's 5-0 rout of Uzbekistan.

Colombia overcomes obdurate DR Congo

Munoz's strike in the second half sends the South Americans to the top of Group K with six points and in to the knockout round of 32

FIFA WORLD CUP
Agence France-Presse
GUADALAJARA

Colombia finally broke down a stubborn DR Congo side on Tuesday to secure a 1-0 win that guaranteed its place in the World Cup knockout rounds.

The victory, courtesy of a 76th-minute goal from Daniel Munoz, took it top of Group K with six points – two clear of Portugal which it will face in the final round.

The South Americans dominated the early stages peppering Lionel Mpasí's goal. Munoz squandered a chance and shortly afterwards had a goal ruled out for offside while James Rodríguez unleashed a stinging shot that was brilliantly saved. Mpasí made further sharp stops from Johan Mojica and Luis Díaz as the Colombians, playing with pace and invention, continued to dominate.



Breaking through: Munoz celebrates after scoring Colombia's winner. REUTERS

THE RESULTS

Group K: Colombia 1 (Munoz 76) bt DR Congo 0.
Group L: England 0 drew with Ghana 0; Panama 0 lost to Croatia 1 (Budimir 54).

test and pose their own occasional threat.

Mpasí made another stunning save with his leg from Díaz in the 50th minute to keep the game goalless.

DR Congo briefly threatened but Crystal Palace defender Munoz made up for his first-half miss when his shot was deflected past a wrong-footed Mpasí.

At 41, Ronaldo shows he still has it in him to deliver

Ayon Sengupta
HOUSTON

For about eight months, the goals had stopped coming in international football.

By Cristiano Ronaldo's standards, that drought felt almost unnatural. His last international goal had come on October 14, 2025, against Hungary, and after a below-par performance in Portugal's opening World Cup game against DR Congo, the critics were circling around.

Thierry Henry used his platform on Fox Sports to make a pointed observation. "One thing that's important, people, please, at home: The team needs to score, not you need to score."

On Tuesday, Ronaldo delivered his answer. He netted twice as Portugal defeated Uzbekistan, ending a barren run that had stretched for long. At 41 years and 138 days, Ronaldo became the second-oldest goal-scorer in World Cup history, behind Roger Milla, who had struck against Russia in 1994 when he was 42 years and 39 days old.

He is now the oldest player to record more than one goal in a men's World Cup game, surpassing the mark his long-time rival Lionel Messi had set against Algeria and then extended further with his twin strike against Austria.

"I'm very happy. But for me, the most important



Relief and belief: Ronaldo lets out his emotions with a trademark SIU after scoring a brace against Uzbekistan. GETTY IMAGES

thing is our work and the confidence we showed," Ronaldo said, perhaps sending a message to the detractors, who had questioned his adaptability as a team man. "The team performed really well and improved a lot. As the saying goes, every cloud has a silver lining. Obviously, speaking personally, records are always nice, but my goal is always to help the national team achieve its objectives."

That response reflected a player who understands his place in the final chapter of a remarkable career. Ronaldo no longer needs to prove he can score goals. He has spent more than two decades doing

precisely that. He, now, seeks one last meaningful run with Portugal.

Roberto Martínez, the Portugal coach, came to Ronaldo's defence. "Our captain is an icon, and he is a role model who works hard for the Portugal team both on the pitch and also in the dressing room. And it is not just the goals he scores but what he creates, the passes he makes. He is already preparing for the next match," Martínez said.

After months of questions and scrutiny, the night brought confirmation that even at 41, Ronaldo remains capable of deciding the biggest occasions.

Stat attack

- 1 Ronaldo is the first player to score in six editions (2006, '10, '14, '18, '22, '26)
- 2 Mendes is the second Portuguese (after Ronaldo vs. Spain, 2018) to find the target off a direct free-kick at the marquee event
- 3 Ronaldo (Portugal) has joined Laudrup (Denmark) and Messi (Argentina) as the youngest and oldest scorer for his country at the quadrennial extravaganza
- 4 Ghana is one of four teams (after Argentina, Mexico and Spain) yet to concede a goal in this year's tournament
- 5 Colombia's Luis Díaz is the first player to be caught off-side five times in a World Cup contest (vs. DR Congo) since Robin van Persie (6 vs. Costa Rica, 2014)
- 10 Ronaldo has gone past Eusebio (9) to become Portugal's top-scorer in the football showpiece

- 13 England has the most goalless draws at the World Cup
- 22y 183d Uzbekistan's Karimov (18y 320d) and Portugal's Ronaldo (41y 138d) had the biggest gap between two starting players in a World Cup game
- 41y 138d Ronaldo is the second oldest to score at the World Cup (after Cameroon's Milla, 42y 39d in 1994)
- 79 England's possession percentage against Ghana, the highest by a team that failed to score in the World Cup in the last 60 years

COMPILED BY ANIRUDH VELAMURI

England left frustrated in a goalless stalemate

Agence France-Presse
FOXBOROUGH

England suffered a FIFA World Cup setback on Tuesday as Thomas Tuchel's side was held to a frustrating 0-0 draw by Ghana, leaving it with work still to do as it bids to progress to the knockout stage as Group L winner.

Nico O'Reilly came closest to scoring with a late header for England that hit the bar, but after the promise of its opening 4-2 victory over Croatia, this was

a performance that will raise doubts as to its chances of going all the way and winning the tournament.

It dominated possession and had 19 shots to its opponents' two, yet rarely looked like scoring past Ghana's stand-in goalkeeper Benjamin Asare.

Both teams have four points with one game still to play in Group L, with progression to the next round all but assured, but their final positions are still in the balance.

Japan, Sweden ready to joust with qualification on the line

Ayon Sengupta
DALLAS

Group F remains delicately poised heading into the final round of matches, and neither Japan nor Sweden will feel entirely comfortable when they meet at the Dallas Stadium.

Both still control their own destinies, but the margin for error is considerably narrower. Japan arrives with momentum after Hajime Moriyasu's side produced one of the performances of the tournament in a 4-0 demolition of Tunisia. With four points and a superior goal difference, Japan knows a draw will guarantee a place in the knockout rounds.

Sweden's journey in this World Cup, however, has been more turbulent. Graham Potter's side opened with an emphatic 5-1 victory over Tunisia but was brought crashing back to earth by a big defeat against the Netherlands.

Despite the setback, Sweden remains well placed on three points. Another point could be enough to secure progression, depending on results elsewhere. Its greatest source of optimism remains up front. The partnership of Viktor Gyokeres and Alexander Isak has the potential to emerge as one of the most dangerous attacking combinations.

Table and fixtures

As the teams head into their final group games, a look at how they are placed and who they meet



GROUP D	M	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Points
USA (Q)	2	2	0	0	6	1	5	6
Australia	2	1	0	1	2	2	0	3
Paraguay	2	1	0	1	2	4	-2	3
Türkiye (E)	2	0	0	2	0	3	-3	0

Friday's matches: Türkiye vs. USA and Paraguay vs. Australia, both 7.30 a.m. IST

GROUP E	M	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Points
Germany (Q)	2	2	0	0	9	2	7	6
Ivory Coast	2	1	0	1	2	2	0	3
Ecuador	2	0	1	1	0	1	-1	1
Curacao	2	0	1	1	1	7	-6	1

Friday's matches: Curacao vs. Ivory Coast and Ecuador vs. Germany, both 1.30 a.m. IST

GROUP F	M	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Points
Netherlands	2	1	1	0	7	3	4	4
Japan	2	1	1	0	6	2	4	4
Sweden	2	1	0	1	6	6	0	3
Tunisia (E)	2	0	0	2	1	9	-8	0

Friday's matches: Japan vs. Sweden and Tunisia vs. Netherlands, both 4.30 a.m. IST

Q: Qualified | E: Eliminated

* The top two from each group and the eight best third-placed sides will advance to the round of 32

nership of Viktor Gyokeres and Alexander Isak has the potential to emerge as one of the most dangerous attacking combinations.

Japan will be without attacking midfielder Takefu-

Misfiring India meets spirited Bangladesh in must-win game

T20 WORLD CUP

P.K. Ajith Kumar
MANCHESTER

They have been here before.

Back to the wall. Must-win game. Followed by must-win game. Again.

The Women in Blue showed they could do that in some style at the ODI World Cup at home just seven months ago. From the brink of elimination, they went all the way to the greatest triumph in the history of Indian women's cricket.

That was one great comeback.

It is time for another one. At the T20 World Cup.

Harmanpreet Kaur's women will take the field against Bangladesh at Old Trafford here on Thursday knowing that they have to deliver. Something they failed to do in their last match, against South Africa, despite promising with both bat and ball.

India had the Proteas struggling at 25 for two after the PowerPlay, and the dangerous captain Laura Wolvaardt was back in the dressing room.

To be fair, the bowlers hadn't got enough runs to defend, but another wicket or two, and not dropping catches, could have put the South Africans under pressure.

Earlier, when India batted, Smriti Mandhana and



D-day: It's now or never for Harmanpreet & Co. X@BCCIWOMEN

Shafali Verma had given their team another rousing start. The middle-order, however, didn't rise to the occasion, yet again.

Of course, India had to deal with an inspired all-round performance by the gritty Marizanne Kapp, who guided her team to victory with what she later described as her best T20 innings.

India needs such a spirited show from its own player or two against Bangladesh.

This Indian team, of course, looks too strong for Bangladesh, and this match may not pose as much a challenge as the one after (against Australia).

But, given the situation they are in, the Indians have to be at their best, even though they appa-

rently have not yet been able to identify their best eleven. India needs more from Harmanpreet and Jemimah Rodrigues, each of whom has in their CV an all-time great ODI innings. Neither has really looked fluent enough.

Smriti, Shafali, Richa Ghosh and Deepti Sharma have been scoring the bulk of India's runs, and they need to take that form into the coming matches. India must be banking on Shree Charani, the newly-crowned No. 1 bowler in T20Is, to continue her marvellous work.

The Bangladesh women will have to be particularly wary of her. They go into the match no doubt buoyed by their win against Pakistan. And they are not under as much pressure as their rivals.

I would say I'm an all-rounder: Shafali

P.K. Ajith Kumar
MANCHESTER

Shafali Verma took the new ball for India against South Africa. She enjoyed every minute of it, giving away just three runs.

Is she seeing herself as an all-rounder these days?

"Yes, I would say I am an all-rounder now," she said, smiling, here on Wednesday, on the eve of India's crucial T20 Women's World Cup match against Bangladesh. "In domestic cricket, playing for Haryana, I have always tried to bowl, as a captain too, and used to think what I could do if I get a chance to bowl for the Indian team."

She revealed she had visualised the very situation (bowling the first over of the innings). "I had prepared for it, and worked

hard. That is why I could execute well," she said. "As a player I would like to put my hand up and serve the team in a given situation."

Shafali said her father had asked her to bowl from her earliest days. "My brother is a leg-spinner and he said I too should bowl," she said. "My father now is happy and tells me it was good that I bowled on those days."

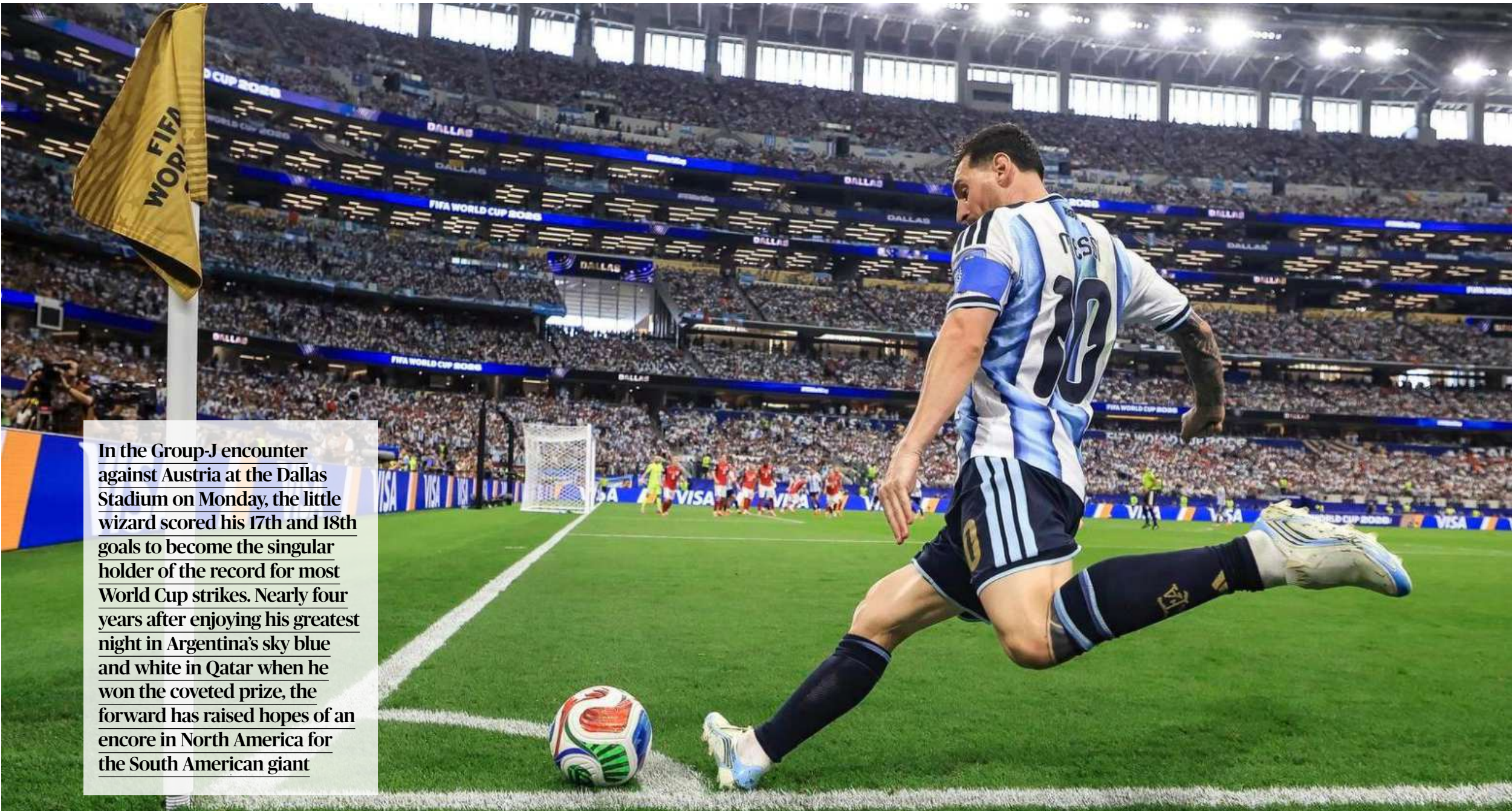
Looking forward to the Bangladesh match, Shafali said: "We can't take any team lightly. They also came here to play good cricket. We will go game by game and try to play our best cricket and try to win that game."

She said the morale was down after the loss to South Africa. "But we motivated each other for our last two group matches".

Today's matches

India	vs.	Bangladesh	South Africa	vs.	Netherlands
Manchester, 7 p.m. IST		Bristol, 11 p.m. IST			
HEAD-TO-HEAD		HEAD-TO-HEAD			
Played: 23		Played: 1			
India	20	Bangladesh	3	South Africa	1
				Netherlands	0
LIVE ON STAR SPORTS 1 & JIHOTSTAR					

Argentina’s Messi-ah keeps the fire burning



In the Group-J encounter against Austria at the Dallas Stadium on Monday, the little wizard scored his 17th and 18th goals to become the singular holder of the record for most World Cup strikes. Nearly four years after enjoying his greatest night in Argentina’s sky blue and white in Qatar when he won the coveted prize, the forward has raised hopes of an encore in North America for the South American giant

Vivek Krishnan

It is the fifth minute of stoppage time. There is a 1-0 lead to protect. There is qualification for the knockout stages of the FIFA World Cup to seal.

With barely a minute left for the final whistle, the practical thing for mere mortals to do would be to take the ball to a distant corner and waste as much of the remaining time as possible.

But when has Lionel Messi, long immortalised in Argentina’s iconic sky blue and white, ever been constrained by the parameters applicable to the rest of the universe? Never, not even at 38 years old, is the answer.

He hares down the right flank with the bounding enthusiasm of a restless teenager, looks up and finds Julian Alvarez sprinting down the middle with an inch-perfect pass.

Alvarez, 13 years younger, takes a couple of touches before shooting straight at goalkeeper Alexander Schlager. By this stage, Messi has positioned himself unmarked in the 18-yard box. He attracts the ball again, and navigates his way around the goalkeeper and another Austrian player before taking aim at goal. The shot is blocked, but he hammers the rebound past a row of bodies and into the back of the net.

In these few frames, the drive and desire of the irrepressible genius from Rosario are perfectly encapsulated. Of course, Messi, who turned 39 on Wednesday, was born to do things with a football that few can envision, let alone execute. But more compellingly, the little wizard, having won the World Cup in Qatar four years ago and conquered everything there is to conquer in the beautiful game, retains the fire within him to light up the global stage at this phase of his extraordinary career.

Perhaps, we shouldn’t be surprised. For, the determination to not let standards drop is a timeless trait that binds otherworldly champions across the sporting landscape – Novak Djokovic, who also turned 39 last month, is another contemporary example from the world of tennis. Xavi drew a parallel with basketball icon Michael Jordan in his column for The Athletic, for there is no footballing equivalent to his former Barcelona teammate in his view.

Another record
Messi’s aforementioned goal in a Group-J encounter against Austria at the Dallas Stadium in Arlington was his second of Monday afternoon in a 2-0 win. It was also his 18th strike across six World Cups. The 17th, which came earlier in the day in the air-conditioned venue, steered him clear of Miroslav Klose as the singular owner of the record for most goals in the history of the quadrennial show-piece. He

could have eclipsed the former Germany striker even earlier in the game if not for sending his penalty wide in the ninth minute, strangely his third miss from the spot in three consecutive World Cups. It is reassuring to know that he can err too.

Otherwise, his tally of World Cup goals is another stratospheric feat in Messi’s long list of individual and collective accolades. During this very tournament, he has become only the third player, after Frenchman Just Fontaine and Brazilian Jairzinho way back, to score in six consecutive World Cup matches – the last time he failed to score was in Argentina’s final group-stage match of the euphoric 2022 campaign against Poland. With his hat-trick against Algeria last week, he also became Argentina’s youngest and oldest scorer in the tournament, a glowing stamp of his longevity.

The game against the Algerians, notably, marked 20 years to the day that he had come off the bench against Serbia and Montenegro for his World Cup debut and scored in the German city of Gelsenkirchen. His was the final goal in a 6-0 win, the only time ever that he has played supporting cast in the marquee event.

Heartbeat
That he is the main man for the Albiceleste – he has scored all five of his team’s goals at this tournament so far – even two decades later appears to blur

the lines between fact and fiction. Never mind the welcome U-turn after announcing his international retirement in 2016, it is nearly four years since his greatest night in an Argentine shirt in Qatar. And still here he is, raising hopes of an encore in North America as the heartbeat of the three-time champion. “When Leo gets activated, everyone gets activated,” Argentina’s head coach Lionel Scaloni told the media after the victory over Austria.

Messi’s record-breaking opening goal on Monday was a fitting example of how the rest of the Argentine players are geared towards facilitating the legend in their midst. Among Messi’s teammates are Enzo Fernandez and Alexis Mac Allister, mainstays in the midfield for elite Premier League clubs. Lautaro Martinez, Inter Milan skipper, finished on top of the goal-scoring charts in the 2025-26 Serie A season. Atletico Madrid’s Alvarez, used as a substitute by Scaloni so far, is keenly sought by Real Madrid. Rodrigo De Paul served Atletico with distinction before joining up with Messi at Inter Miami in Major League Soccer (MLS). Yet, if all of them want to intuitively look for one man as often as possible on the pitch, it is telling of Messi’s unabated greatness.

They did exactly that in the 38th minute. Messi, with his back towards the Austrian goal, started the move by finding Thiago Almada in the middle of the park. The 25-year-old Atletico Madrid winger

charged with the ball towards the edge of the 18-yard box, and then fed it out wide to Facundo Medina on the left. The left-back could have offered a cross past the last line of defence for Lautaro to latch onto, but instead passed the ball back in the direction that it came from. In anticipation of the great man running in behind him, Almada let the ball go between his legs, aptly for Messi to pass the ball past Schlager’s outstretched right arm and pump his right fist in celebration.

In a career as long as his, Messi has scored every category of goal imaginable. There have been unstoppable long-range thunderbolts and free-kicks, mesmerising solo runs, delectable chips and quintessential fox-in-the-box finishes. But if there is a type of goal that is synonymous with him, it has to be his unflinching propensity to pick his spot in the corner, open up his body and caress the ball into the net with his majestic left foot from the edge of the box.

Complementing his sublime skill and avid affection for the game is a razor-sharp brain too. It lends to his innate understanding of where he needs to be at any given juncture. He can no longer press the opposition with the intensity that a younger version of himself could, nor make gut-busting runs beyond the defence in the hope that a teammate finds him. Against Austria, as he often did in the previous World Cup, he covered a distance of nearly five kilometres merely by walking. It appears antithetical to the very essence of the sport, but it is simply his way of conserving energy in his twilight for the key moments that require him to inject his magic.

For Messi to be in the necessary physical shape for the rigours of a World Cup, the move to the MLS in 2023 has also helped. Even though the profile of the American league has grown in recent years, there isn’t as much strain on Messi’s wearing body from playing for Inter Miami as there would have been if he was still plying his trade in Europe. Without needing to operate at full throttle all the time, he has still become the fastest to 50 goals in MLS history.

Looking ahead, will Messi’s goal-scoring record in the World Cup be breached? Possibly in this very tournament, given that France’s talisman Kylian Mbappe, 27, is just two behind the Argentine. But to help understand Messi’s legacy, the climax of Argentina’s duel against Austria was instructive as well as poignant. As the television cameras panned to an old lady in the audience, she held up a banner that read, ‘100-year-old Messi fan’.

Beyond all the goals and trophies won, Messi spreads unadulterated joy to millions around the world like her. There can be no greater endorsement of his legacy.

THE GIST

▼ Messi’s record-breaking opening goal on Monday was a fitting example of how the rest of the Argentine players are geared towards facilitating the legend in their midst

▼ Complementing his sublime skill and avid affection for the game is a razor-sharp brain too. It lends to his innate understanding of where he needs to be at any given juncture

▼ For Messi to be in the necessary physical shape for the rigours of a World Cup, the move to the MLS in 2023 has also helped. Without needing to operate at full throttle all the time, he has still become the fastest to 50 goals in MLS history



Kingmakers: meet the insects that make India’s favourite mangoes

A study has found that allowing wild insects to access flowers dramatically increased mango yield by 350%, highlighting the importance of wild insects for mango pollination; yet, native bees that transfer pollen around orchards are under threat from the insecticides that protect the crop from pests

Kavitha Kannan

More than a thousand varieties of mangoes exist in India, the popular ones being Banganapalli, Dassheri, Alphonso, Badaami, Imaam Pasandh, and Malgoa. There is even a “Lalbagh” variety in Bengaluru. Many of us associate the fruit with a summer childhood memory, of eating it with our bare hands, the mango juice dripping on our clothes. More recently, the fruit has become popular on social media platforms, where users explain hundreds of ways to cook and eat it. This year, the fruit’s popularity reached a new height: the red carpet at the Met Gala in New York. Mangoes and Indian summers go hand-in-hand, yet do you know how this fruit comes to be? In other words, the mango tree gives out flowers... and then what happens?

Making a mango

Between December and March every year, mango trees across the country bloom and issue a sweet yet slightly fermented odour. Look closer at a mango tree in this time and you will find a branch with several bouquets of small, cream-coloured flowers. Each branch, which botanists call a panicle, contains a few hundred to up to 10,000 individual flowers. And a single mango tree can carry up to some 3,000 panicles, depending on its size and branching. Each one of these flowers is the start of a mango in the making. Some flowers carry only the male parts while others only the female parts, and sometimes there can be flowers with both (which are biologically called hermaphrodites). Regardless, for the mango to form, pollen must travel between these flowers.

This is where pollinators make their mark. There is a curious history here. Mango cultivars had once insisted that mango flowers are pollinated only by wind. But this theory could not explain why the flowers issued a sweet odour. It had to be to attract insects. To confirm that insects were indeed pollinators, researchers in Bengaluru teamed up with their peers from Germany to survey several Badami mango farms in the city’s urban and rural areas. Their findings, published in 2023, were striking: “We found that allowing flowers access to ants and flying visitors (bees, hoverflies, nonsyrphid flies), dramatically increased mango yield by 350%, highlighting the importance of wild insects for mango pollination,” the study paper read. These flying insects were found to include wild bees such as the dwarf honey bee (*Apis florea*), giant honey bee (*Apis dorsata*), and stingless bees (*Tetragonula sp.*). Other important flying visitors included hoverflies, which look like bees (*Syrphus sp.*), the common house fly (*Musca domestica*), and the blow fly (Calliphoridae family).

Effective pollination

The researchers also observed that the mango yields dropped when they barred crawling insects, such as ants, from the flowers. Soubadra Devy, a senior researcher at the Ashoka Trust for



Fruit test: Visitors at a stall during a three-day mango and jackfruit fest organised by Shivamogga HOPCOMS in Karnataka in the first week of June. Attaching a monetary value to the crops could nudge policy towards actively protecting pollinators, through changes at the farm and landscape levels. S.K. DINESH

Research in Ecology and the Environment, Bengaluru, and an author of the study, said ants are “messy pollinators” and that it is essential to investigate them as pollinators of mango in future studies. Dr. Devy also said she anticipates that the pollinator community is not any different for other Indian mango varieties since the “floral traits, i.e. the flower structure, pollen, and nectar are likely to be very similar”. Researchers have conducted similar studies in Mexico, on the ‘Ataulfo’ mango, and in Australia, on the ‘Kensington Pride’ variety – and have revealed similar findings. Both teams also took more steps to determine which insects were the pollinators. They calculated a ‘pollination effectiveness’ metric based on the abundance of pollinators, the number of visits to flowers (with a ‘legitimate’ visits quantified using video cameras on trees), and the number of pollen grains deposited. And both studies showed that wild and native insects were most efficient at pollination, producing a higher yield of fruits. Non-native bees to Mexico, such as European honey bees (*Apis mellifera*), were abundant and contributed to 80% of the pollination. Paradoxically, however, that did not result in a higher yield. The reason was that these non-native bees stayed around the same trees or in the same orchard and delivered the wrong

pollen, resulting in malformed fruits. On the other hand, the native bees transferred pollen between orchards, giving rise to more full and juicy fruits. **Farmers’ friends** Yet these native bees are under threat from the same insecticides that protect the mango crop from pests. Neonicotinoid insecticides, which are commonly sprayed on mango trees, are neurotoxic and affect cognitive functions in bees, such as navigation, learning, and memory, and eventually their survival. This ripples through the entire colony, as the insecticides travel to the pollen and nectar and are brought back to the hive by bees. The Bengaluru-based study observed that fewer bees visited the mango flowers, and the harvested fruits were lighter by almost 30%, resulting in a three-way loss for the farmer: expensive pesticides, loss of pollinators, and a loss in the fruit yield. Dr. Devy said monoculture farms that prevail in rural areas are more prone to pest attacks, and hence suffer higher pollinator loss as well. However, she also said she sees hope in bee-safe pesticides and in farmers timing their sprays to avoid peak pollinator activity – practices already in use in several western countries. “One recent welcome move”, in her words, was the Indian government recognising pollinators in the country’s new ‘environmental accounting’

framework. This framework recognised that India has more than 800 bee species, plus butterflies, moths, beetles, birds, bats and flies as pollinators and that they are ecologically important for agriculture. The government has also attached a monetary value equivalent to 8-10% of the total crop output value, amounting to ₹2.6 lakh crore in 2021-22, to pollinators. **Rights of pollinators** Attaching a monetary value could nudge policy towards actively protecting our pollinators, through changes at the farm and landscape levels. These could include, as the Mexico study suggested, increasing the spread of natural and semi-natural areas near orchards, such as native forest patches and wildflower strips, to attract more wild insects. Dr. Devy also pointed out that in May, stingless bees in Peru had become the first insects to win the legal rights to exist, thrive, and be represented in court. This is significant for the conservation of the species against insecticides, climate change, and competition from non-native insects. The question then arises: will India accord similar rights to its pollinators, which carry the weight of the country’s agriculture? As you relish this season’s mangoes, it could also be your food for thought. (Kavitha Kannan is a biologist and science writer. kavithakannan1994@gmail.com)



Artisanal gold miners work at a mining site in Mongbwalu, Ituri Province, DRC on June 16. AFP

Gold miners keep working despite Ebola crisis in DRC

Agence France-Presse

In the mines of Mongbwalu, the epicentre of an Ebola outbreak in the northeastern Democratic Republic Congo (DRC), gold prospectors have no choice but to overcome their fear of the virus and carry on their backbreaking work. “Ebola is real and it scares us. But if I stay at home, what are my children going to eat?” Justin Okame, an artisanal digger, asked. The DRC’s 17th Ebola outbreak was declared on May 15 after several unexplained deaths in Mongbwalu in the mineral-rich but volatile Ituri province. It has claimed more than 250 lives with 1,000 cases in the vast central African nation but the real extent of the crisis is difficult to assess. In total, 209 people have been infected in Mongbwalu, 89 of whom have died, according to official figures.

The DRC’s 17th Ebola outbreak was declared on May 15 after several unexplained deaths in Mongbwalu in the mineral-rich but volatile Ituri province

Several miners were among the victims, Richard Lokudu, the head of the local hospital, said. Behind one miner, greasy, sticky earth stretched as far as the eye could see. The ochre landscape was pockmarked with holes that dozens of artisanal miners tirelessly dug through. Men and women caken in mud broke up rocks that were then crushed to free the gold particles. They spend hours side by side, sweating and wearing themselves out in dire health and safety conditions. Some come from other provinces or neighbouring countries such as Uganda, hoping to earn a few hundred dollars a week, at best. Jeannette Akelo, a mother of seven and day labourer at the open-pit site, said that the diggers had no choice: they must continue to work “to survive”. The current outbreak is caused by the Bundibugyo strain for which there is no vaccine or specific treatment. Existing Ebola vaccines, developed between 2018 and 2019, are only effective against the Zaire strain, which has caused previous major outbreaks. In the hills of the rural commune, Red Cross workers in full protective suits have regularly intervened over the past few weeks to wrap bodies and prevent post-mortem transmission of the virus. In the DRC, most gold production comes from artisanal mining. After long hours, some stopped to eat a plate of rice with a gravy made from leaves. Others preferred not to waste time. With their bare hands, they mixed mercury into the brownish material extracted from the ground. The small greyish, heavy, shiny lump that formed will, once heated, turn into raw gold. “We don’t know who is infected or not, and after work everyone goes home,” Jean-Baptiste Liwawi said. The digger said he took ginger and some concoctions to ward off infection. Since the start of the outbreak, many patients have preferred to consult traditional healers rather than go to hospitals. Public mistrust runs deep in a region that has for years been ravaged by violence waged by various armed groups, which regularly carry out massacres. In Ituri, almost all gold deposits are controlled by community-based militias, who derive substantial income particularly through the imposition of taxes, according to UN experts. Most of the illegally mined gold is smuggled to Uganda, the experts said in a report on the DRC at the end of 2025.

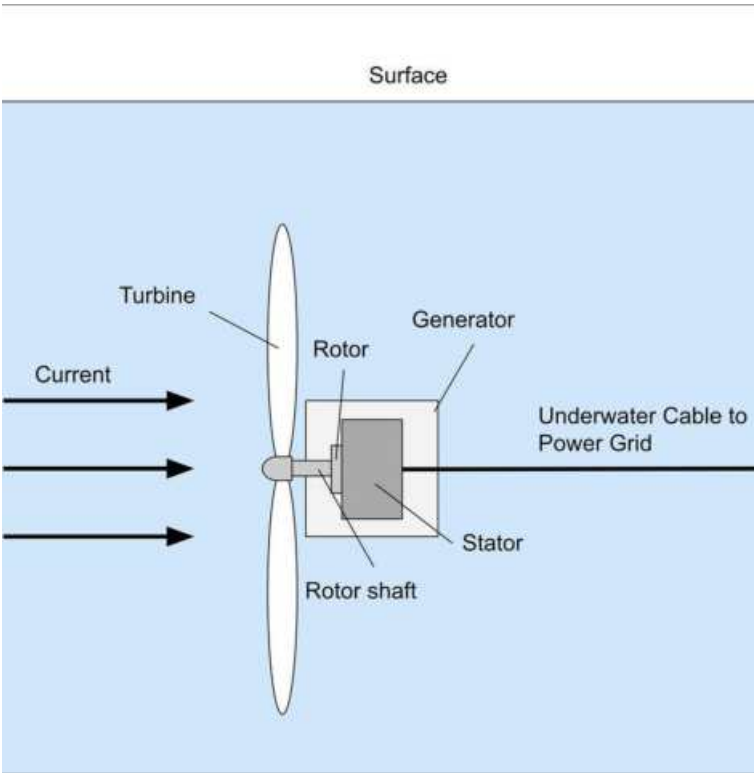
THE SCIENCE QUIZ

Unusual sources of energy

Vasudevan Mukunth

- QUESTION 1**
X uses a planet's gravity to change a spacecraft's speed and direction without using fuel. As the spacecraft swings by, it gains (or loses) momentum relative to the sun, borrowing a small bit of the planet's orbital energy. The Voyager missions famously used this technique to get to the outer Solar System. Name X.
- QUESTION 2**
In 1969, the physicist Roger Penrose proposed that energy can be extracted from a rotating black hole. Within the _____ — the region just outside the event horizon — an object can be split in two, with one fragment spiralling into the black hole and the other escaping, carrying away more energy than it started with. Fill in the blank.
- QUESTION 3**
MHD generators produce electricity by passing an electrically conductive fluid, like an ionised gas, through a magnetic field. The

- moving charged particles induce a current, converting kinetic and thermal energy into electricity, no turbines needed. MHD generators are also highly efficient, but still experimental. What does MHD stand for?
- QUESTION 4**
A quantum physical phenomenon called the Y effect where two parallel, uncharged conducting plates placed really close together feel a force pulling them together. It arises because the plates restrict which virtual particles can exist between them versus outside, creating an unequal pressure from which a very small amount of energy can be extracted. Name Y.
- QUESTION 5**
Name the form of power that generates electricity from the difference in salt concentration between seawater and freshwater. As water flows across a semi-permeable membrane towards the saltier side, pressure builds between them and drives a turbine.



Visual: Name the turbine type described here. PUBLIC DOMAIN

- Answers to June 18 quiz:**
- When something you’ve just noticed seems to be everywhere – **Ans: Baader-Meinhof phenomenon**
 - Angle by which object flips in Dzhanibekov effect – **Ans: 180°**
 - Effect when a shampoo stream ‘leaps’ upwards – **Ans: Kaye effect**
 - When people respond to safety measures with more risk-taking – **Ans: Peltzman effect**
 - Star for whom information suppression backfiring effect is named – **Ans: Barbara Streisand**
- Visual: Magnus force**
- First contact:**
Tamal Biswas | K.N. Viswanathan | Anmol Agrawal | Pankaj Gharde | Prem Nath Tiwari

For feedback and suggestions for ‘Science’, please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject ‘Daily page’

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

New tuberculosis cases found in Maharashtra in 35 days

6,111 Maharashtra has detected 6,111 new tuberculosis (TB) cases within the first 35 days of the Centre's 100-day TB-Free India campaign, while 11,091 villages in the State were identified as high-risk through an AI-based assessment system. Villages in Nagpur, Yavatmal, Amravati, Nashik and Raigad were among those identified. PTI

Children killed by Israel between October 2023-2025

20,000 An inquiry under the UN Human Rights Council called Independent International Commission of Inquiry on the Occupied Palestinian Territory, said in its report on Tuesday that 30% of the Palestinians killed from October 2023 to October 2025, over 20,000 in total, were children. PTI

Number of persons who lost their food stamps in the U.S.

4.7 Over 4.7 million people have lost Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program benefits, also known as food stamps, since U.S. President Donald Trump's signature tax and spending law took effect last July, as per data through March from the U.S. Department of Agriculture. Changes to U.S.'s second-largest social safety-net programme took hold fastest in Arizona. PTI

Monthly transaction volumes on BHIM app in May

244 In million. The transaction volumes of the BHIM Payments App more than tripled between June 2025 and May 2026, according to NPCI BHIM Services Limited. Monthly transaction volumes on the app, developed by NPCI BHIM Services Limited, rose from 79.64 million in June 2025 to 244 million in May 2026, a release said on Wednesday. PTI

Number of Syrian convicts transferred home by Lebanon

128 Lebanon has transferred 128 Syrian convicts to their home country, a Lebanese security source said on Wednesday, marking the second batch of handovers under an agreement the two sides signed earlier this year. Overcrowded Lebanese prisons host around 2,000 Syrian nationals held on various charges. AFP

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Why was the *NewsClick* case quashed?

Did *NewsClick* violate FDI rules or FEMA regulations? How did the absence of an FDI cap at the time affect the case? What role did the RBI's approval play in the ruling? What happened in the UAPA case against Prabir Purkayastha?

EXPLAINER

Aaratrika Bhaumik

The story so far:

The Delhi High Court has quashed the first information report (FIR) registered by the Economic Offences Wing (EOW) of the Delhi Police and the consequent money laundering proceedings initiated by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) against news portal *NewsClick* and its editor-in-chief, Prabir Purkayastha, over allegations of foreign funding. Holding the action to be a “mala fide and arbitrary” exercise of power, Justice Neena Bansal Krishna said it amounted to an abuse of the legal process and posed a threat to free and independent journalism.

What were the allegations against *NewsClick*?

The proceedings stemmed from two cases registered in 2020 by the EOW of the Delhi Police and the ED. The EOW case originated from a letter dated June 26, 2020, written by Sobhan Singh, who was an informant and not an aggrieved party, to the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting, alleging that PPK NewsClick Studios Pvt. Ltd. had misappropriated funds and violated foreign direct investment (FDI) norms. The communication was subsequently forwarded by Vijay Kaushik, Under Secretary in the Ministry, following which the EOW registered an FIR.

The FIR alleged that *NewsClick* had received an investment of \$1.5 million from Worldwide Media Holdings LLC, a Delaware-based entity in the United States, at an inflated share valuation. The investigating agency claimed that the premium at which the shares were issued was intended to circumvent the 26% cap on foreign investment in digital news media. However, the investment agreement had been signed in March 2018, and the funds received in April 2018, more than a year before the 26% cap was introduced through a government press note on September 18, 2019.

The allegation that *NewsClick* had manipulated its share valuation also formed the basis of the alleged violations under the Foreign Exchange Management (Transfer or Issue of Security by a Person Resident Outside India) Regulations, 2017 (FEMA). The regulations require that shares issued by an Indian entity to a foreign investor be valued in accordance with an internationally accepted pricing methodology and not be transferred below fair value.

The record also showed that, before receiving the investment, *NewsClick* had written to the Information and Broadcasting Ministry in December 2017 seeking clarification on whether online news portals were subject to the FDI restrictions applicable to print media. In January 2018, the Ministry responded that “online publications on website/web portal do not fall under the ambit of print media”.

During the proceedings, reference was made to a status report dated July 26, 2021, signed by Assistant Commissioner of Police Anil Kumar of the EOW and supplied to *NewsClick*'s counsel. The report incorporated a response from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) stating that the foreign remittance had come through the automatic route and that no FEMA violation was disclosed.



Journalists protest police actions against news portal *NewsClick* at Press Club of India, New Delhi, in October, 2023. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

However, on July 29, 2021, the state sought to distance itself from the report and requested permission from the court to file a fresh status report. When a revised report was eventually filed on October 4, 2021, the RBI's observations were omitted. The EOW nevertheless maintained that *NewsClick*, despite being a loss-making entity, had received FDI at inflated valuations and alleged that the share valuation mechanism had been used to bypass regulatory restrictions. It further claimed that 45% of the foreign investment had been diverted.

Within a week of the FIR being registered, the ED initiated proceedings under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) by registering an Enforcement Case Information Report (ECIR), similar to an FIR, on the basis of the same allegations. The predicate offences cited in the FIR included criminal breach of trust, cheating and criminal conspiracy.

How did the UAPA case against *NewsClick* unfold?

Apart from the proceedings under FEMA and the PMLA, Mr. Purkayastha and *NewsClick*'s head of human resources, Amit Chakravarty, also faced prosecution under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA). In October 2023, the Special Cell of the Delhi Police arrested the duo following a report published by *The New York Times* alleging links between *NewsClick*'s funding and Chinese state-backed propaganda efforts. Mr. Chakravarty subsequently turned approver and was released from custody.

Mr. Purkayastha remained in Tihar Jail for nearly seven months before the Supreme Court, in May 2024, declared his arrest illegal and set aside the remand order. The court found that neither he nor his counsel had been furnished with the written grounds of arrest before he was remanded to custody.

A Bench comprising Justices B.R. Gavai and Sandeep Mehta held that communication of the grounds of arrest in writing by the investigating agency was “sacrosanct and cannot be breached under any situation”. The Bench observed that failure to furnish the grounds of arrest would violate the fundamental right guaranteed under Article 22(1) of the Constitution, which provides that no arrested person shall be detained without being informed of the grounds of arrest and shall not be denied

the right to consult and be defended by a legal practitioner of their choice.

Accordingly, Mr. Purkayastha was thereafter released on the grounds of not being provided a “communication of the grounds of arrest in written”, thus vitiating the arrest and subsequent remand.

What were the court's findings on the alleged FDI violations?

On the allegation of FDI violations, the court noted that the correspondence issued by the RBI approving the transaction between *NewsClick* and Worldwide Media Holdings LLC was sufficient to demonstrate that no violation had occurred. The court reasoned that the transaction had been cleared by the very regulator within whose domain the alleged offence fell. It also took note of the fact that no FDI cap on digital news media existed at the time the investment was made.

Justice Krishna also rejected the State's allegation that over 45% of the foreign investment had been siphoned off through salary payments, consultancy fees and rent. Referring to the company's financial records, the court noted that its expenditure exceeded its revenue during the relevant period.

“When a company is functioning, especially in the business of digital print media, such expenses are bound to occur. Even if it is accepted that there were overpayments and excessive expenditure incurred by the petitioner, it does not disclose any criminal offence. The allegation of siphoning is, therefore, not tenable,” the judge said.

Why did the court find that the offences of cheating and criminal breach of trust were not made out?

With regard to the offences of cheating under Section 415 of the Indian Penal Code (IPC) and criminal breach of trust under Section 406, the court pointed to the absence of any aggrieved party. It noted that Worldwide Media Holdings LLC, the entity that had invested funds in *NewsClick*, had never lodged any criminal complaint. The court further observed that the prosecution had failed to identify any person who could be said to have been deceived, cheated or otherwise suffered any grievance on account of the transaction.

The court also highlighted that Mr. Singh, on whose complaint the FIR was

registered, had no direct involvement in the transaction. It held that a commercial investment made in exchange for shares could not, by itself, amount to an entrustment of property so as to attract the offence of criminal breach of trust.

What did the court say about the money laundering charge?

The ED's money laundering case was primarily based on the allegation that Mr. Purkayastha and others had conspired to bring foreign funds into India through an investment in *NewsClick*. It is alleged that ₹9.59 crore (approximately \$1.5 million) was routed into the country under the guise of an investment in digital media, thereby attracting the offence of criminal conspiracy under Section 120B of the IPC. According to the agency, Mr. Purkayastha had colluded with Jason Pfletcher of Worldwide Media Holdings LLC and American businessman Neville Roy Singham in facilitating the inflow of funds.

The court, however, rejected the contention and pointed out that a charge of conspiracy requires material indicating an agreement to commit an illegal act or to achieve a lawful objective through unlawful means. Apart from what it described as “bald assertions”, the court found no material to suggest the existence of any such agreement or unlawful design. It further noted that despite the ED carrying out extensive investigations for nearly a year and a half, during which the petitioners and several employees were repeatedly summoned, no incriminating material had been placed on record.

“Aside from bald assertions of there being a criminal conspiracy, there is not a whisper of any incriminating allegation which would even remotely suggest the commission of the offence punishable under Section 4 of the PMLA (punishment for money laundering),” the court observed.

Having found the allegation of criminal conspiracy untenable, the court went on to hold that the ED's money laundering case could not survive once the underlying FIR was quashed. Relying on the Supreme Court's decision in *Vijay Madanlal Choudhary v. Union of India* (2022), it observed that where the predicate offence is set aside, money laundering proceedings founded on the same set of allegations cannot be sustained against the accused. Consequently, the ECIR was also quashed.

THE GIST

▼ The FIR alleged that *NewsClick* had received an investment of \$1.5 million from Worldwide Media Holdings LLC, a Delaware-based entity in the United States, at an inflated share valuation.

▼ The court noted that the correspondence issued by the RBI approving the transaction between *NewsClick* and Worldwide Media Holdings LLC was sufficient to demonstrate that no violation had occurred.

▼ The court held that in the absence of any aggrieved party, charges of cheating and criminal breach of trust could not be made out.

